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Initial public offer of equity shares on the main board platform of BSE Limited ("BSE") and National Stock Exchange of India Limited ("NSE", and together with BSE, the "Stock Exchanges") in compliance with Chapter II of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Issue of Capital and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2018, as amended ("SEBI ICDR Regulations").



(Please scan this QR Code to view the RHP and Abridged Prospectus)



LALITHAA JEWELLERY MART LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Our Company was incorporated under the name of "Lalitha Jewellery Mart Private Limited", as a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated November 26, 1985, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Tamil Nadu & Andaman at Chennai ("RoC"). Subsequently, the name of our Company was changed from "Lalitha Jewellery Mart Private Limited" to "Lalithaa Jewellery Mart Private Limited" pursuant to a fresh certificate of incorporation consequent upon change of name, dated November 4, 2013, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Tamil Nadu & Andaman at Chennai. Subsequently, our Company was converted from a private limited company into a public company pursuant to the Board resolution dated November 23, 2023 and the special resolution dated December 18, 2023 passed by our Shareholders and consequently the name of our Company was changed to "Lalithaa Jewellery Mart Limited" and a fresh certificate of incorporation dated January 5, 2024 was issued by the RoC. For further details of change in name of our Company, please refer to the section titled "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 280 of the Red Herring Prospectus dated August 9, 2026 to be read with the Corrigendum to the Red Herring Prospectus dated August 17, 2026 ("RHP") to be filed with the RoC.

Corporate Identity Number: U36911TN1985PLC012417
Registered Office: 123, Usman Road T. Nagar, Chennai – 600017, Tamil Nadu, India. Corporate Office: ICON Savithri Ganesh No.53, Habibullah Road, T. Nagar, Chennai – 600017, Tamil Nadu, India.
Contact Person: Jitendra Kumar Pal, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; E-mail: cosec@lalithaajewellery.com; Telephone: +044 2834 9860; Website: www.lalithaajewellery.com

OUR PROMOTERS: M. KIRAN KUMAR JAIN AND HEMAA KIRAN KUMAR JAIN

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹5 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF LALITHAA JEWELLERY MART LIMITED (THE "COMPANY") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹17,000 MILLION ("OFFER"). THE OFFER COMPRISES A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹12,000 MILLION BY OUR COMPANY (THE "FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES ("OFFERED SHARES") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹5,000 MILLION BY M. KIRAN KUMAR JAIN (THE "PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER", AND SUCH OFFER FOR SALE OF EQUITY SHARES BY THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER, THE "OFFER FOR SALE"). THE OFFER WILL CONSTITUTE [•]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY. THIS OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹60.00 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [•]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY) FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES (THE "EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). OUR COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS, MAY OFFER A DISCOUNT OF UP TO 10 % (EQUIVALENT OF ₹19 PER EQUITY SHARE) TO THE OFFER PRICE TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING UNDER THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT"). THE OFFER LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [•]% AND [•]%, RESPECTIVELY OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE BY THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER			
NAME OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDER	TYPE	NUMBER OF SHARES OFFERED/ AMOUNT (IN ₹ MILLION)	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (IN ₹)*
M. Kiran Kumar Jain	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [•] Equity Shares of face value ₹ 5 aggregating up to ₹ 5,000 million	3.51

*As certified by the R.K. Chapawat & Co., Chartered Accountants, by way of their certificate dated August 9, 2026.

PRICE BAND: ₹190 TO ₹201 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹5 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 38.00 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹5 EACH AND THE CAP PRICE IS 40.20 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES. BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 74 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹5 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 74 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹5 EACH THEREAFTER. THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FINANCIAL YEAR ENDED 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END (I.E. CAP PRICE) OF THE PRICE BAND IS 9.95 TIMES AND AT THE LOWER END (I.E. FLOOR PRICE) OF THE PRICE BAND IS 9.41 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 29.69 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026. WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NETWORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCAL YEARS IS 30.55%.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹19 PER EQUITY SHARE OF ₹5 EACH IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.

The details of the Fresh Issue, Offer for Sale and the post Offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	OFFER SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION			
	At Floor Price of ₹190 per equity share		At Cap Price of ₹201 per equity share	
	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹5 each	Up to Amount (₹ in Million)	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹5 each	Up to Amount (₹ in Million)
Fresh Issue	63,192,982	12,000.00 ^a	59,732,655	12,000.00 ^a
Offer For Sale	26,315,789	5,000.00	24,875,621	5,000.00
Total Offer Size	89,508,771	17,000.00	84,608,276	17,000.00
Post Offer Market Capitalization*	563,170,138	106,995.66	559,709,811	112,495.41

*Market capitalisation is computed as the total equity shares outstanding post Offer by the upper and lower ends of the Price Band, as applicable. | ^aThe Offer includes Employee Reservation Portion and a discount of ₹19 per Equity Share is being offered to the Eligible Employees bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion. The amount is after the adjustment of the number of equity shares to be allotted in the Employee Reservation Portion at the Employee Discount.

BID/ OFFER PERIOD	BID/ OFFER OPEN
	BID/ OFFER CLOSES ON WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 19, 2026*

*UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on the Bid/ Offer Closing Date.

We are a jewellery retailer operating under the brand name "Lalithaa", primarily selling diverse range of gold jewellery along with other offerings including silver and diamond jewellery across styles, designed to cater to regional preferences of the southern Indian jewellery markets.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS 2018.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARDS OF BSE LIMITED AND NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED. BSE LIMITED SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

• QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET OFFER • NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER

• RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET OFFER • EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹5 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹60.00 MILLION

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RHP AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES/ REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER ("BRLMS").

In accordance with the recommendation of a committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated August 10, 2026, the above provided price band is justified based on quantitative factors/ key performance indicators ("KPIs") disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section on page 135 of the RHP vis-a-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary and secondary transaction(s), as applicable, as disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section beginning on the page 135 of the RHP and provided below in this advertisement.

In relation to the Price Band, potential investors should only refer to this price band advertisement for the Offer and should not rely on any media articles/ reports in relation to the valuation of our Company as these are not endorsed, published or confirmed either by the Company or by the BRLMS.

Risk to Investors

For details, refer to section titled "Risk Factors" on page 22 of the RHP.

1. **Revenue dependence on sale of gold jewellery:** Our revenues have been significantly dependent on sale of gold jewellery, which accounted for 92.33%, 94.58% and 93.96% of our revenue from operations, for the Financial Years 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Accordingly, any factors adversely affecting our sales of gold jewellery, such as, an increase in international gold prices, higher import duties or regulatory restrictions, decline in consumer discretionary spending, shift in consumer preferences to alternatives, etc. may negatively impact our business, financial condition, results of operations and prospects.

2. **Negative operating cash flows in the past:** We have experienced negative cash flows from operating activities of ₹3,977.62 million and ₹180.02 million in Fiscal 2026 and in Fiscal 2024 respectively, due to lower customer enrolment towards the Company's jewellery schemes and increased settlement of trade payables and cannot assure you that we will not experience negative cash flows in future periods. Negative cash flows may adversely affect our financial condition, results of operations and prospects.

Particulars	Fiscal 2026 ₹ in million	Fiscal 2025 ₹ in million	Fiscal 2024 ₹ in million
Net cash (used in) / generated from operating activities	(3,977.62)	2,887.31	(180.02)

3. **Risk related to customer advances:** We receive advances from our customers under various schemes introduced by us. The amounts received in the schemes amount to more than 10% of our revenue from operations for the respective financial periods. Inability to appropriate such advances received from customers under jewellery purchase schemes may adversely impact our revenues and results of operations and future profitability.

Particulars	Financial Year ended March 31, 2026		Financial Year ended March 31, 2025		Financial Year ended March 31, 2024	
	(₹) in million	% of total revenue from operations	(₹) in million	% of total revenue from operations	(₹) in million	% of total revenue from operations
Advances from customers	50,427.50	20.15%	31,454.10	18.61%	19,432.26	11.58%

4. **Dependence on In-house Manufacturing and Karigars for jewellery manufacturing:** In Fiscal 2026, we operated our Manufacturing Facilities with 672 Karigars employed by our Company and 144 Karigars employed by Asita Jewellery Manufacturing Private Limited ("Asita") for manufacturing of our products. These Karigars who are on the rolls of our Company and Asita, manufactured 79.11%, 80.66% and 79.78% of our total products available for sale for Fiscal 2026, Fiscal 2025 and Fiscal 2024, respectively. Further, we have entered into short term agreements with 296 Karigars (as of March 31, 2026), on a non-exclusive basis, for manufacture and supply of jewellery. Our Company is dependent on these Karigars for manufacturing our products and any disruptions at our Manufacturing Facilities, or loss of these Karigars or failure of these Karigars to adhere to the relevant quality standards may have a negative effect on our reputation, business and financial condition.

5. **High working capital requirement:** Our business requires a substantial amount of working capital for operations including for financing the purchase of raw materials. We intend to continue growing by setting up new stores (including inventory requirements) and increase our focus on sale of jewellery. We may need to seek additional financing in the normal course of business from time to time as we expand our operations and any inability in obtaining such additional funds in a timely manner may adversely affect our business, growth plans, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows. The table

below sets out our working capital for the years/period set out:

Particulars	Fiscal 2026	Fiscal 2025	Fiscal 2024
Working capital requirements* (in ₹ million)	44,661.08	25,768.29	22,835.41
Revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	250,239.27	168,973.17	167,880.52
Working capital as percentage of revenue from operations	17.85%	15.25%	13.60%

*Working capital requirement is computed as sum of Inventory and trade receivables minus trade payables minus advance from customers as at the year end.

6. **Dependence on top three suppliers of raw materials:** We are dependent on our top three suppliers of raw materials who have contributed 58.03%, 67.20% and 66.98% in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively of our total cost of raw materials. We typically procure gold through purchase orders and do not enter into any long-term agreements with our suppliers. In the event our suppliers are unable to provide us the required quantity of raw materials, or if we are unable to find alternate suppliers at commercially acceptable terms, our ability to manufacture our products in a timely manner will be adversely affected leading to an adverse impact on our business, results of operations and financial condition.

7. **Usage of brand "Lalithaa" and payment of Brand Ambassador fees:** Our business is significantly dependent on the reputation and awareness of our brand, "Lalithaa". Any failure to maintain our reputation, enhance our brand recognition or increase positive awareness of our products, it may be difficult to maintain and grow our consumer base, which could have a material adverse effect on our financial condition, results of operations, business and growth prospects. Further, our Promoter received brand ambassador fees of 0.30% of revenue in Fiscal 2024; this arrangement has since been terminated.

8. **Geographical concentration risk:** As of March 31, 2026, we operate 61 stores in 51 cities across Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Telangana and Puducherry. As of March 31, 2026, we have 23 stores in Andhra Pradesh, 20 stores in Tamil Nadu, 7 in Karnataka, 10 in Telangana and 1 in Puducherry. The geographic concentration of all (100%) our stores in the southern regions of India heightens our exposure to adverse developments related to competition, economic downturn and demographic changes in these regions, which may adversely affect our business prospects, financial conditions and results of operations.

9. **Seasonal Fluctuation Risk:** In India, the demand of jewellery is mainly driven by weddings, festivals, birth and the harvest season. We have historically experienced certain seasonal fluctuations, reflecting higher sales volumes during festival periods and other occasions such as Akshay Tritiya, Durga Puja, Dhanteras, Diwali, Poila and Baisakh. Any slowdown in demand for our jewellery during peak seasons or failure by us to accurately anticipate and prepare for such seasonal fluctuations could have an adverse effect on our business, financial condition and results of operations.

10. **Competition Risk:** We operate in highly competitive and fragmented markets, and our market share may get adversely affected due to competition in these markets which is based primarily on market trends, pricing and customer preferences. We face competition from both the organized and unorganised sectors of the jewellery retail business, including online marketplaces. Competitors may have significant advantages such as stronger distribution networks, brand recall, promotional offers for customers, technical and financial capabilities. Consequently, we may not be able to compete successfully in the future against our existing or potential competitors, or we cannot assure you that our business and results of operations will not be adversely affected by increased competition in the offline and online channels.

11. **Risk related to jewellery designs and continuous innovation:** We have an in-house jewellery designing team of fifteen members responsible for introducing new and innovative designs for our jewelleryeries. Our in-house design team comprises of managers and skilled professionals consisting of CAD (Computer-Aided Design) designers who work on digital design,

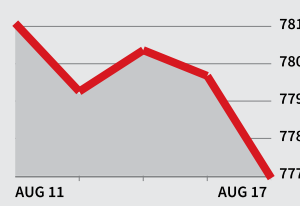
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CM YK

J CH-CHE

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77728.16 (-281.09)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24287.65	-78.35
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.59	-0.08
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.60	+0.18
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	153550.00	+1797
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	235642.00	+1800

REFORM PUSH.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman says the Centre will soon form a panel for ‘Banking for Viksit Bharat’ **p3**



DE-ROSTERED.

Two Air India Group pilots fail preliminary tests for psychoactive substance consumption **p9**

QUICKLY.

NEW BJP TEAM

Ram Madhav, Vasundhara, Smriti Irani get key roles



New Delhi: BJP President Nitin Nabin on Monday announced national office-bearers, bringing several prominent leaders back into the party's central organisational structure. Former Rajasthan CM Vasundhara Raje Scindia and ex-general secretary Ram Madhav were named National Vice-Presidents. Former Union Minister Smriti Irani has been named National General Secretary. **p11**

TARIFF PROTECTION

Reliance Jio brings back Prime Membership plan

Mumbai: Reliance Jio has reintroduced its Prime Membership Programme, offering subscribers a one-year price guarantee on eligible plans amid concerns over tariff hikes. The membership will remain separate from the base ₹299 plan and comes with additional benefits, including Google Gemini Pro and 5,000 GB of cloud storage. **p2**

El Nino seen deepening India's rainfall deficit through Sept

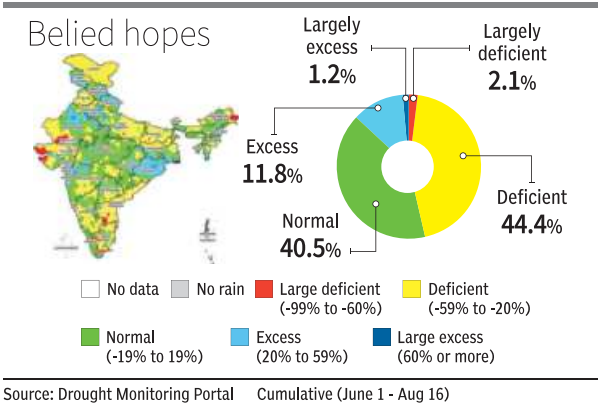
DRIER DAYS. European forecaster says best of monsoon over for India; overall shortfall at 13%

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

India appears to be facing a widening rainfall deficit, with the current regional wet spell likely to fade by end-August as the influence of drought-inducing El Nino strengthens, according to the European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF).

A leaner rainfall trend could persist through September due to El Nino's influence on the South-West monsoon. In effect, India may already have seen the best of this year's monsoon, with withdrawal expected to begin from North-West India around mid-September, the European weather agency's outlook said.

India's private weather forecaster Skymet has downgraded its outlook for the South-West monsoon to 85 per cent of the long-period average. On Monday, it predicted a 70 per cent chance of drought. The all-India monsoon deficit stood at 13 per cent as of August 16 and is



expected to widen through September.

EAST, N-E WORST HIT

East and North-East India, the worst-hit, have a 27 per cent deficit, followed by the South Peninsula at 21 per cent. North-West India has a 12 per cent deficit, while Central India remains relatively comfortable down just 1 per cent, according to the India Meteorological Department data.

Among individual meteorological subdivisions, Arunachal Pradesh's deficit is the highest at 39 per cent, closely followed by Assam

and Meghalaya at 38 per cent each.

Punjab and coastal Andhra Pradesh are both 36 per cent below normal, while Rayalaseema is at 35 per cent.

The government's drought monitoring portal showed that more than 45 per cent of the 6,363 *tehsils* in the country are rain deficient so far this monsoon.

OTHER AGENCIES

Last week, the Climate Prediction Center of the US, an arm of the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, said El Nino was strengthening, with a more

than 90 per cent chance of a very strong event during the Northern Hemisphere autumn and winter of 2026-27.

The rainfall projections come despite the IMD locating a low-pressure area near Kolkata on Monday, with the monsoon holding firm over East and North-East India.

The IMD said the best prospects for meaningful additional rain through the rest of August remain concentrated over East and North-East India.

For much of the country, the monsoon may now be entering its leaner final stretch. However, the Bay of Bengal may witness the formation of at least one more low-pressure system before August ends.

KHARIF SOWING

Despite deficient rainfall, the kharif sowing deficit has narrowed to less than 1 per cent in the week ended August 14 from 21 per cent as of July 5.

Paddy and nutri-cereals are witnessing acreage deficits of 3.7 per cent and 2.4 per cent, respectively. Overall, kharif sowing has crossed 1,000 lakh hectares.

ECMS expanded with nod for 31 projects at ₹7,877 cr outlay

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The Union government on Monday approved 31 more projects under the Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS), marking the first domestic manufacture of several critical components and raw materials, including filters, coils, speakers, acetylene black and electrolyte additives.

The latest approvals, involving an investment of ₹7,877 crore, take the total number of projects approved under the scheme to 106, with a cumulative investment commitment of ₹69,548 crore across 30 products in 15 States.

The government said 38 plants are already operational, while another 16 are at advanced stages of construction. The projects are expected to generate direct employment for 74,628 people, and total direct and indirect employment of around 2.5 lakh.

BOOSTING GROWTH

“When we announced the ECMS, there was a lot of scepticism whether we will be able to make components

The latest approvals take the total number of projects approved under the scheme to 106

in India — how difficult or easy would it be. This was something which many of the industry participants and even many policymakers were sceptical about... The latest approvals include first-ever domestic manufacturing of diverse critical components such as filters, coils and speakers, as also essential raw materials such as acetylene black and electrolyte additives,” said Ashwini Vaishnaw, Minister of Electronics and Information Technology.

PRODUCTS-WISE NODS

The scheme is boosting self-reliance and economic growth, with production capacity now meeting the entire domestic demand in many areas. For instance, output already exceeds demand in anode material (around 110 per cent), Optical Transceiver-SFP (350 per cent) and relays (200 per cent), he said.

Approvals for manufacturing connectors have been given to Amphenol Interconnect India, Ennovi Mobility Solutions India, and Rosenberger Interconnect; for making relays to Allied Engineering Works and Gruner India; transducers to Centum Electronics and Sensata Technologies India; filters to Centum Electronics; and capacitors to Globe Capacitors.

Similarly, for coils, approval has been provided to Syрма SGS Technology; metal shielding covers to Wangda Technologies; speakers and microphones to Brandworks Precision Manufacturing; antennas to Britannia RFID Technologies India; and enclosures to Micromax Precision Moulding, the Ministry of Electronics and IT (MeitY) said.

The ECMS, launched in April 2025, provides incentives for establishing domestic manufacturing facilities for both Indian and export markets.

The projects approved so far are expected to generate ₹5.34 lakh crore in production, with investments spread across States including Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Telangana and Uttar Pradesh.

+ BSE, NSE shorter-tenor securities borrowing contracts may boost CAS

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

Stock exchanges have introduced shorter-tenor securities lending and borrowing (SLB) contracts to improve short-term liquidity and to boost participation in the new closing auction session (CAS), according to people familiar with the discussions.

The three-working-day contracts, launched by NSE Clearing and BSE Clearing from Monday, will allow market participants to borrow securities for a much shorter period. Sources said this is particularly relevant for CAS, which has faced concerns over low participation and price spikes since its launch earlier this month.

The move follows recent discussions between the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), brokers and market infrastructure institutions on improving participation in CAS, people with knowledge of the matter said.

“This is essentially one of the measures being looked at to improve participation in CAS. If participants are able to borrow securities through SLB for three days, it could make short-term trades in the closing auction more viable,” said an exchange source.

DEEPEN THE MARKET

The exchanges said that the new contracts will provide greater flexibility for short-term securities borrowing and delivery requirements and help deepen the SLB market. BSE Clearing also said the shorter tenor can facilitate inter-exchange arbitrage and improve price alignment across trading venues.

Dhiraj Relli, MD and CEO of HDFC Securities, said the T+3 contracts should be helpful for the closing auction and increase overall market depth.

“However, we will have to wait and see how volumes pick up,” he said.

The new contracts will be generated daily and initially be available only for stocks eligible in the equity derivatives segment. Repay, recall and rollover facilities will not be available.

WILL AID CAS

On the sidelines of a cyber-defence event at NISM on Monday, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said CAS is “here to stay for sure” and that greater participation is critical for the mechanism.

Pandey said SEBI will come out with a draft paper on a reformed SLB mechanism soon. “It will definitely help in CAS because we would need more participation. SLBM improves CAS participation and that has been our goal. We have a working group... I can only say very soon that means there is a sense of urgency. But at the same time different participants need to be heard.”

“CAS is a major micro-structure... It really depends on our success in terms of attracting FPIs, allowing passive investing, which is already 30 per cent of the market, and we cannot just put out this thing on this issue just because some people want to do options trading in the way they want to do options trading,” he said. The earlier system of determining closing prices using the volume-weighted average price of trades during the final 30 minutes was replaced by CAS, which determines a single equilibrium closing price by matching buy and sell orders.

The rollout triggered concerns over sharp price spikes amid low participation and liquidity. SEBI has maintained that the mechanism needs time to settle down while it continues to monitor data and industry feedback.

One in five Nifty 50 CEOs in the ₹50-crore pay club

Sourashis Banerjee
Chennai

Pay packets of top executives at some of India's largest listed companies rose sharply in FY26, with one-fifth of these business leaders earning ₹50 crore and above, and many recording sharp increases in their remuneration.

A *businessline* analysis of data from company annual reports revealed that HCL Technologies' C Vijayakumar took home the highest remuneration in FY26, followed by Larsen & Toubro's SN Subrahmanyam.

Asian Paints MD & CEO

Amit Syngle recorded the steepest increase in his pay at 179 per cent.

TECH CEOS DOMINATE

The tech sector remained the most generous employer with HCL Tech, Infosys, Tech Mahindra and Wipro featuring among the top 10 companies with hefty leadership pay packets. But infra and auto majors such as L&T, M&M, Bajaj Auto, JSW Steel, Hindalco Industries and Ultratech Cement also rewarded their top leaders well.

Subrahmanyam's ₹120.84 crore remuneration put him comfortably ahead of Infosys MD & CEO Salil Parekh, who received ₹82.60 crore in

Pay-packets of top honchos

Annual remuneration of Nifty50 leaders (in ₹ crore)		Remuneration received in foreign currency (in million)	
	C Vijayakumar HCL Technologies MD & CEO		SN Subrahmanyam Larsen & Toubro Chairman & MD
	Salil Parekh Infosys MD & CEO		Rajeev Jain Bajaj Finance Vice Chairman & MD
	Mohit Joshi Tech Mahindra MD & CEO		
170.55	\$18.1	120.84	
82.60		73.34	
		69.73	\$5.4

Source: Company annual reports

FY26. Subrahmanyam's pay also increased 58.5 per cent over FY25, placing him among the executives recording the largest increases during the year.

The remuneration of two technology executives in the

Nifty-50 bracket is reported in foreign currencies. HCL Tech's Vijayakumar received \$18.13 million in FY26, following a pay revision. This led to his annual remuneration increasing 67 per cent in FY26, amounting roughly to

₹171 crore at the exchange rate on March 31, 2026. Tech Mahindra MD & CEO Mohit Joshi received ₹5.4 million, in FY26, amounting to ₹70 crore. Interestingly, N Chandrasekaran, Chairman of Tata Sons, which is unlis-

ted, received ₹158.66 crore in FY26, making him one of the highest paid India Inc leaders. Reliance Industries' Chairman and MD Mukesh Ambani, Interglobe Aviation's MD Rahul Bhatia and Eternal's new CEO Albinder Singh Dhindsa are among the top 50 heads who voluntarily waived their remunerations.

JUMPS IN CEO PAYS

The biggest percentage jump in CEO pay was seen in Asian Paints at 179 per cent over FY25. Cipla followed with a 122.7 per cent increase. Jio Financial Services, NTPC and PowerGrid were other companies which recorded large increases in CEO pay.



OLIRUM ERODU FOUNDATION

ON BEHALF OF THE KONGU REGION SOCIETY · ERODE, TAMIL NADU

In 1993, a teenager boarded a milk truck to Bengaluru carrying **10 kilograms of paneer**. Today, that paneer is worth **₹10,700 crore** on the stock exchange.

Congratulations, Milky Mist!

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QUICKLY.

Unemployment rate
dips to 5.1% in July

New Delhi: The overall unemployment rate among persons aged 15 years and above declined to 5.1 per cent in July from 5.5 per cent in the previous month, according to a government survey. According to the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) conducted by the National Statistics Office, released on Monday, the unemployment rate among persons aged 15 years and above was 4.5 per cent in rural areas, down from 5 per cent in the previous month. The urban UR remained steady at 6.7 per cent in July 2026 compared to 6.6 per cent in June 2026. **PTI**

Govt to fill two
member posts in CCI

New Delhi: The government has invited applications for filling posts for members at the Competition Commission of India (CCI). The appointments will be for five years from the date of joining or till the age of 65 years, whichever is earlier, according to a notice by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs. Eligible candidates can apply until September 28. **PTI**

Yes Bank makes bond
market comeback years
after AT1 write-off

Bloomberg

Yes Bank Ltd is returning to the bond market for the first time since the Indian private lender wrote off a risky local note in 2020, and has hired arrangers for a dollar issuance, according to people familiar with the matter. The bank plans to sell a benchmark-sized three-year US currency note and is holding calls with fixed-income investors starting Monday, said the people who asked not to be identified because the information is private. The proposed sale comes at a time when other Indian lenders have raised \$5.27 billion in two months, spurred by the Reserve Bank of India's measures in June

Axis Bank prices Senior Notes
aggregating \$300 m at 5.179%

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Axis Bank has priced its Senior Notes, maturing on November 21, 2029, aggregating \$300 million at 5.179 per cent per annum. Banks are mobilising dollar denominated funds to provide leverage to their non-resident Indian customers so that they can place higher quantum of fresh FCNR-B deposits back with

US may emerge as India's top LPG supplier: OPEC

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The US is expected to become India's top liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) supplier, replacing the Middle East Gulf (MEG), accounting for more than half of the in-bound shipments for the world's second largest consumer of the commodity. OPEC, in its latest monthly oil marketing report, said, "In line with a 2025 sales agreement between India and the US for LPG, the US is expected to emerge as India's largest LPG supplier, accounting for about 55 per cent of India's imports." This is expected to offset some of the losses from West Asia due to the supply bottlenecks that severely restricted LPG demand in the country, it added.

DEMAND OUTLOOK Accordingly, India's oil demand will increase by about 0.2 million barrels per day (mb/d) y-o-y in Q3 2026. Meanwhile, preliminary data from the Petroleum

Govt to form 'Banking for Viksit Bharat' panel soon: FM

REFORM PUSH. Nirmala Sitharaman asks public sector banks to leverage strong balance sheets for the next phase of growth

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday called on public sector banks (PSBs) to capitalise on their historically low non-performing assets (NPAs) and robust balance sheets to drive economic expansion and propel structural reforms. Speaking at a two-day conclave of PSB and financial institution chiefs, Sitharaman announced that the high-level committee on 'Banking for Viksit Bharat', proposed in the Union Budget, will be constituted shortly.

SCOPE FOR REFORMS Emphasising the urgency of the 2047 target, the Finance Minister said that Indian banking is positioned at an unprecedented point of financial resilience after years of balance sheet cleanup. "The NPAs are at the lowest ever Indian banking has seen and, therefore, there cannot be a better position of



GROWTH ASPIRATIONS. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman with SBI Chairman Challa Sreenivasulu Setty (centre) and RBI Executive Director R Lakshmi Kanth Rao at the PSB Confluence 2026 in New Delhi on Monday **ANI**

strength from which to drive reforms," she stated, urging lenders to take the lead in financing the nation's long-term growth agenda. Further, she said the government would soon constitute a high-level panel on 'Banking for Viksit Bharat'. In this year's Budget, the

Finance Minister had proposed a high-level committee on 'Banking for Viksit Bharat' to comprehensively review the sector and align it with India's next phase of growth. "We expect the announcement of the high-powered committee to look into the banking sector," she

said, adding that the committee would give its thoughts and recommendations to the government. "The ideas are going to be from the field, from the executives, as it were and once the high-level committee on banking for Viksit Bharat forms its views and

recommendations, we'll be ready to rev up the Indian economy," she said. **FOCUS ON YOUTH** Sitharaman stressed the need for banks to focus particularly on the country's young population, noting that 29 per cent of Indians

were in the 15-29 age group. Banks need to expand access to financial services for young people, including education loans, entrepreneurship finance and investment products. She also called on the banking sector to generate practical, implementable ideas to meet emerging financing needs, saying the sector should be ready to "press the button or pedal to rev up the Indian economy" once the banking committee issues its recommendations. Addressing the conference, Sanjay Lohiya, Financial Services Secretary, said the asset quality of PSBs had improved sharply, with gross NPAs declining from a peak of 14.6 per cent in March 2018 to a record low of 1.93 per cent in March 2026. Net NPAs fell from 8 per cent to 2.39 per cent during the same period. The improvement has strengthened PSB balance sheets and enhanced their capacity to support growth, Lohiya said. However, he said banks

would need to sharpen their competitiveness as technology reshapes business models, customer expectations evolve and new areas of economic activity emerge. "The next imperative is to sustain this momentum and leverage the financial strength achieved for quality business growth," he said. **DEPOSIT MOBILISATION** Lohiya identified deposit mobilisation as a key priority, amid changing household savings preferences. Banks would need to strengthen their deposit base through better service, convenience, product innovation and sustained customer relationships. He also highlighted opportunities in financing global capability centres, agriculture and horticulture value chains, and priority-sector lending. Banks should move beyond conventional farm credit to finance storage, cold chains, processing, logistics, packaging and marketing linkages.

India seeks WTO consultations with US
over 4-year quartz surface tariff quota

Amiti Sen
New Delhi



SAFEGUARD MEASURE

- The US has imposed a four-year tariff-rate quota on imports of quartz surface products, effective August 15
- The measure covers quartz slabs and other fabricated quartz surface products
- India is among the largest exporters of quartz surface products to the US

India has sought consultations at the World Trade Organization (WTO) with the US over Washington's new safeguard measure on imports of quartz surface products, a move that could hit Indian exporters who have emerged as one of the largest suppliers to the US market. The US has imposed a four-year tariff-rate quota (TRQ) on imports of quartz surface products, effective August 15, after the US International Trade Commission (USITC) found that increased imports were causing serious injury to American industry. The measure covers quartz slabs and other fabricated quartz surface products.

"Having a substantial interest, India requests consultations with USA under Article 12.3, AoS (agreement on safeguards), with a view to reviewing the information provided under Article 12.1, AoS and exchanging views on the proposed measure. India would like to propose that the consultations mentioned above take place virtually as per mutual convenience of both sides," according to a submission made by India at the WTO.

25% TARIFFS As per the USITC's recommendations, imports of items within the quota will incur a 25 per cent tariff in the first year, while ship-

ments exceeding the quota will face 40 per cent duty. Both rates will decline by one percentage point each year over four years, reaching 22 per cent and 37 per cent, respectively, in the fourth year. "During the period of investigation, India, Vietnam, Spain and Thailand were major exporting countries," the US notification to the WTO on August 4 noted. **INDIAN QUARTZ** The safeguard is particularly significant for India because the US is a major destination for its quartz surface products. The Federation of Quartz Surface Manufacturers of India had earlier stated that about 95 per cent of India's quartz surface production is exported to the US, with 2024-25 exports valued at about \$700 million. The quartz surface

products covered under the safeguard duty include slabs and other surfaces created from a mixture of materials that includes predominantly silica (such as quartz, quartz powder, cristobalite and glass powder) as well as a resin binder (such as an unsaturated polyester), according to the US. **WTO DISPUTE BODY** The US is required to respond to the request within 10 days and enter into consultations within 30 days, unless the two sides agree otherwise. The consultations will be confidential and are intended to find a mutually satisfactory solution. If the consultations fail to resolve the dispute within 60 days from India's request, the government can ask the WTO's Dispute Settlement Body to establish a panel and fight it out legally.

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www.pageind.com | investors@jockeyindia.com | CIN#: L18101KA1994PLC016554

NOTICE FOR THE EQUITY SHAREHOLDERS OF THE COMPANY

This notice is published pursuant to the provisions of the Investor Education and Protection Fund Authority (Accounting, Audit, Transfer and Refund) Rules, 2016 ("the Rules") notified by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs.

The rules inter-alia, contain provisions for transfer of all shares in respect of which dividend has not been claimed by the shareholders for seven immediate preceding consecutive years or more in the name of Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF) Suspense Account.

Complying with the requirements set out in the rules, all shares in respect of which Second Interim Dividend for the financial year 2019-20 is due for transfer and the Company has simultaneously communicated to the concerned shareholders individually whose shares are liable to be transferred to IEPF Suspense Account under the said Rules for taking appropriate action(s) at their latest available address.

The Company has also uploaded the details of such shareholders and shares due for transfer to the IEPF suspense account on its website at <https://pageind.com> Shareholders are requested to refer investors section of the website to verify the details of unencashed dividends and the shares liable to be transferred to the IEPF suspense account.

In case the Company does not receive any communication from the concerned shareholders on or before December 14, 2026, Shareholders may note that both the unclaimed dividend and corresponding shares transferred to IEPF Authority/Suspense Account including all benefits accruing on such shares, if any, can be claimed back by them from IEPF Authority after following the procedure prescribed by the Rules.

In case of any enquiries, please contact the Company or the Registrar and Share Transfer Agent Link Intime India Private Limited at their following address/ email/ telephone number.

Company Secretarial Dept,
Page Industries Limited,
Umiya Business Bay-Tower-1, 7th floor,
Cessna Business Park, Kadubeesanahalli,
Varthur Hobli, Bengaluru- 560103
Ph: +91-80-49454545
Email: investors@jockeyindia.com
Web site : www.pageind.com

Mr. Manohar Shirwadkar,
MUFG Intime India Private Limited, Unit:
Page Industries Limited,
C 101, 247 Park, L BS Marg, Vikhroli West,
Mumbai - 400083. Maharashtra
Tel No: +91 22 49186000
E-Mail: rnt.helpdesk@in.mrms.mufg.com

Place: Bengaluru
Date: 12 August 2026

For Page Industries Limited
Murugesh C.
Company Secretary
ACS:21787

**Paradeep Phosphates Limited**

CIN: L20122OR1981PLC001020
Registered Office: 5th Floor, Orissa State Handloom Weavers' Co-Operative Building, Pandit J N Marg, Bhubaneswar - 751 001 Tel: 0674 666 6100.
Corporate Office: Adventz Centre, 3rd Floor, No. 28, Union Street, Off Cubbon Road, Bengaluru - 560001.
Tel: 080 4681 2500/555 **E-mail:** cs.ppl@adventz.com **Website:** www.paradeepphosphates.com

INFORMATION REGARDING 44th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING TO BE HELD THROUGH VIDEO CONFERENCING/OTHER AUDIO VISUAL MEANS AND NOTICE OF RECORD DATE

Shareholders may note that 44th Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Company will be held at 3:00 P.M. on Thursday, September 17, 2026 through Video Conferencing (VC) and Other Audio Visual Means (OAVM) in Compliance with applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013, General Circular Nos. 14/2020 dated April 08, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, 20/2020 dated May 05, 2020, 02/2021 dated January 13, 2021, 02/2022 dated May 05, 2022, 10/2022 dated December 28, 2022, 09/2023 dated September 25, 2023, 09/2024 dated September 19, 2024 and 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 issued by Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA), (hereinafter collectively referred to as "MCA Circulars") and Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations"), to transact the business that will be set forth in the Notice of the Meeting.

In compliance with the above MCA circulars and Listing Regulations, notice of 44th AGM and Annual Report for the Financial Year 2025-26, will be sent to those shareholders whose email ids are registered with the Company or MUFG Intime India Private Limited (Registrar and Share Transfer Agent or "RTA" of the Company) or Depository Participant(s). The Notice of the AGM and Annual Report will also be made available on the website of the Company at www.paradeepphosphates.com and website of the Stock Exchanges at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com.

A letter providing the weblink for accessing the annual report for the Financial Year 2025-26 will be sent to those shareholders who have not registered their email address. The shareholders may register/update their email address and/or bank account details, by following the procedure mentioned below:

- For shareholders holding shares in physical form:** Please send duly filled Schedule Form, ISR-1 (available on the website of the Company at <https://www.paradeepphosphates.com/investors/kyc-compliance>) along with requisite documents to the RTA of the Company i.e., MUFG Intime India Private Limited (Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited), Unit: Paradeep Phosphates Limited, C-101, Embassy 247, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai - 400 083.
- For shareholders holding shares in demat form:** Please register/update your email address and/or bank account details through your depository participant(s).

The shareholders will have an opportunity to cast their vote remotely on the business as set forth in the Notice of the AGM through electronic voting system. The manner of voting remotely will be provided in the Notice of AGM which will be made available on the website of the Company at www.paradeepphosphates.com and website of the Stock Exchanges at www.bseindia.com and [!\[\]\(1b4c558ddf9b892c474b406846621877_img.jpg\)!\[\]\(8086a6b4bd413c816c0eb523ce237c57_img.jpg\)!\[\]\(cd227b35902a1702c503a1e86e7338af_img.jpg\)!\[\]\(87153cb7023fa0b6122f089e6fdebe4b_img.jpg\)!\[\]\(112a4e34cdc6f5db20ac32c8c881039c_img.jpg\)!\[\]\(be9ee3b51f1d49f98874c57f52d3c7f3_img.jpg\)!\[\]\(babfabaad54926b71de57dfd5157b10e_img.jpg\)!\[\]\(e2475d24a96f999aed0e1aae28d4e46f_img.jpg\)!\[\]\(99066bdbe8690425cbc90e9ca5793387_img.jpg\)

M CH-CHE](http://www.nseindia.com.</p><p>Dividend & Record Date: The shareholders may note that, the Board of Directors in their meeting held on May 11, 2026 has recommended a dividend of Rs. 1.50 per equity share of Rs. 10 each for the year ended March 31, 2026. The record date for determining entitlement of members for the FY 2026 is fixed as September 04, 2026. The final dividend if approved at the AGM, will be paid, subject to deduction of tax at source (TDS), within the statutory time. The shareholders may note that, w.e.f. April 01, 2024, any payment including dividend is to be paid in electronic mode only. Accordingly, shareholders are requested to update their KYC and to notify change in bank account details, if any by following the procedure mentioned above.</p></div><div><div>Place : Bengaluru
Date : August 17, 2026</div><div>For Paradeep Phosphates Limited
Sachin Patil
Company Secretary</div></div></div><div data-bbox=)

Trading charges

India should call out US’ transshipment scam’ report

Last week, the Trump administration brought out a report called ‘The Great Transshipment Scam’, which implicates India as one of the 40 countries which simply re-route Chinese goods to the US and helps China duck punitive US tariffs. Of the 40 blacklisted countries and blocs, India has been put down in Tier-1 category of worst offenders in volume-terms, alongside the EU, Canada, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, Israel and Mexico.



The report, in a nutshell, is alleging large scale violation of rules of origin (ROO). But the report cites no evidence to show that India has violated ROO, or transshipped goods without value addition. It has cited a specific instance of pumps and compressors exported from the Pune-Gujarat-Chennai region. Analysts have, however, pointed out that there is considerable industrial capacity here. Export volumes of pumps to the US and rest of the world exceed imports from China, suggesting value addition. In the case of compressors, there seems to be domestic absorption of imports. India should urge the US to disclose country, product and shipment details of ‘illegal transshipment’. According to the US Commerce Department, “\$67 billion in US-bound goods were transshipped from China through the top hubs — Mexico, India, and Vietnam — in 2025, producing an estimated \$28 billion in lost tariff revenue”. It is not known what India’s share in this amount is.

The Commerce Department says that imports from China fell by roughly \$109 billion in 2025, while imports from other countries rose by roughly \$156 billion. The report cites these two trends — that China’s share in US exports fell from 20 per cent in 2018 to 10 per cent in 2024, while that of the 40 countries mentioned in the report rose from 70 per cent to 80 per cent — to conclude that China is routing goods through the latter. This is unconvincing, as there could have been value addition. Besides, if China’s goods are entering the US despite the best efforts to stop them, it signals a failure of Trump’s tariff offensive (which actually began in 2018 against China) to shore up US manufacturing. The Trump administration cannot easily explain a tariff policy that has not curbed overall imports or enhanced US production. It is now looking for global scapegoats. The report could be a precursor to another round of tariffs under Section 301 and Section 232.

India has no reason to be perturbed. It has not been hugely impacted by US tariffs so far, which were at 50 per cent levels between August 2025 and February 2026. Exports to the US, as to the rest of the world have been flat in FY26 — also because about 40 per cent of India’s exports to the US are outside the punitive tariffs list. This scenario is unlikely to change even if new tariffs are introduced, because the US cannot perhaps risk supply and price shocks in important products. A knee-jerk response to US’ moves or statements is best avoided. India should counter this report factually. However, it must also look into the growing import intensity of its exports.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH



G VENKAT RAMAN

The current disruption in the Strait of Hormuz is revealing that its significance extends well beyond oil, gas, and petrochemicals. Disruptions to energy, industrial gases and specialised chemical inputs are exposing strategic dependencies in sectors far removed from the Gulf, including semiconductor manufacturing and the industries that depend upon advanced chips.

Hormuz is, therefore, more than an energy and shipping chokepoint. It illustrates how disruption at one point in the global economy can expose strategic dependencies several tiers away from the original source. A company may have no factory, supplier, or customer anywhere near the Gulf and still discover that a critical input, technology, or production capability ultimately depends upon flows affected by it. What appears to be a geographically distant geopolitical risk can therefore become an enterprise-level vulnerability.

This points to a larger challenge for global business. Firms have spent the past several years diversifying suppliers, relocating production and building alternative logistics routes in response to geopolitical risk. These measures can reduce geographical concentration, but they do not necessarily eliminate the strategic dependencies embedded within the wider production network. The real chokepoint may lie several tiers upstream, in a difficult-to-replace technology or capability, or increasingly in data and digital infrastructure.

The question firms increasingly need to ask is therefore not simply: Where is our network located? It is: What does our network ultimately depend upon?

Answering that question requires looking beyond conventional supply chains towards the wider architecture of dependence underlying the enterprise. A company may depend on critical inputs, components, energy, and logistics routes. But it may also depend on specialised equipment, intellectual property, software, manufacturing know-how and skills. Increasingly, data, cloud infrastructure, platforms, algorithms, and connectivity constitute another layer of dependence. Strategic dependency boundaries often extend far beyond the legal boundaries of the firm.

Not every dependency, however, constitutes a strategic vulnerability. Four factors help distinguish routine dependencies from potential chokepoints: criticality, concentration, substitutability, and time sensitivity. How critical is the dependency to operations or competitiveness? How concentrated is its supply, capability, or control? How easily and quickly can it be



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

substituted? And how long can the organisation operate before disruption begins to hurt? The more critical and concentrated a dependency is, the more difficult it is to substitute, and the more time-sensitive it becomes, the greater its strategic significance.

The difficulty is that some of these dependencies may be invisible to senior management. Firms typically understand their immediate suppliers better than suppliers several tiers upstream. Yet an obscure chemical, industrial gas, piece of equipment or logistics route deep inside a production network can become the point through which geopolitical disruption eventually reaches the firm. A company’s operational footprint and its dependency footprint may therefore look quite different.

Technology makes the problem still more complicated. With a conventional supply dependency, managers ask whether another company can supply the input. With a technological dependency, the deeper question is whether someone else possesses an equivalent capability to produce or replicate what is required.

Multiple suppliers therefore do not necessarily represent genuine technological alternatives. A firm may diversify its chip suppliers, for instance, but those suppliers may still depend on ASML for the extreme ultraviolet (EUV) lithography equipment required to produce the most advanced chips. The apparent diversification of suppliers can

Reducing dependence may increase autonomy and control, but it can also mean higher costs, slower deployment, or loss of access to superior capabilities

therefore conceal concentration in the underlying technological capability.

Semiconductors illustrate the distinction. TSMC’s expanding manufacturing presence in Arizona reduces the geographical concentration of advanced chip production. Yet manufacturing capacity is only one element of the semiconductor ecosystem. Advanced packaging, accumulated process capabilities, specialised skills, and supplier networks also matter. Replicating a fabrication facility is therefore different from replicating the technological ecosystem surrounding it. Geographic diversification does not automatically produce capability diversification.

There is another complication. Strategic dependence can sometimes be the source of competitive advantage. Ford’s relationship with China’s CATL illustrates the dilemma. Access to CATL’s battery technology can support the development of US battery manufacturing capability, but the relationship has simultaneously attracted political scrutiny over technological dependence on China.

DIFFICULT CHOICE

This creates a difficult choice for firms. Reducing dependence may increase autonomy and control, but it can also mean higher costs, slower deployment, or loss of access to superior capabilities. Dependence can therefore create vulnerability and competitive advantage simultaneously.

Strategic dependence can also arise in digital ecosystems, although in a different form. A platform that becomes deeply embedded in a country’s information environment can create dependence on digital infrastructure whose critical elements remain externally controlled. TikTok illustrates the problem. Its scale in the US has turned questions about access to user data and ultimate control over its

recommendation algorithm into matters of national security. The strategic dependence here lies not in a physical input or production capability, but in reliance on a digital platform whose data and algorithmic architecture may remain outside domestic control. The concern is therefore not merely data privacy. Dependence on a foreign-controlled digital platform can create vulnerabilities involving data access, jurisdiction, and potential influence over the information environment, which can in turn acquire national-security significance.

The managerial response cannot therefore simply be to eliminate dependence. Different chokepoints require different responses. Excessive supplier concentration may justify diversification. Low substitutability may require developing alternatives. Poor upstream visibility requires deeper mapping. Short disruption tolerance may justify buffers and redundancy. Critical technological dependence may require capability-building or partnerships.

Data and digital exposure may demand different governance and architectural choices. Some dependencies may simply have to be managed rather than eliminated.

In an era when economic interdependence increasingly intersects with national security, firms therefore need to look beyond the geography of their global footprint. The strategic question is no longer only where the enterprise sources, manufactures, and sells. It is whether management understands the deeper architecture on which all those activities depend.

The next frontier of geopolitical risk management may therefore be less about mapping countries and more about mapping dependencies.

The writer is Professor, Humanities and Social Sciences, IIM Indore. Views are personal

Focus on building rural economic clusters

Connecting coops, FPOs and SHGs with finance, skills and infrastructure will enable local producers capture that value

S Mahendra Dev
KK Tripathy

In his 80th Independence Day address, the Prime Minister gave a clarion call to recalibrate and harmonise national development paradigms, reenergising the foundational architecture required to achieve a Viksit Bharat by 2047. The declaration on Saptadharā (Seven Streams) strengthens the case for a bottom-up model of rural development.

India’s development architecture has constantly evolved in the quest for greater efficiency, coherence and impact. The Government carried out restructuring of Centrally Sponsored Schemes (CSSs) to rationalise and eliminate overlap and fragmentation, enhance financial efficiency, strengthen accountability and give States/UTs greater ownership in implementation.

An extensive rural development ecosystem exists, but its components do not always work together. A farmer may receive production support; a cooperative or Farmer Producer Organisation (FPO) may facilitate aggregation; an individual or a group entrepreneur may receive assistance for an enterprise; and a village may benefit from infrastructure — yet the missing link around the rural value chain is the connection between producers and institutions, institutions and

infrastructure, enterprises and finance/skills, and production and processing/markets. The answer to sustainable community development lies in a simple distinction: a programme can support an activity; a rural economic cluster can build an economy around it. India has programmes covering effectively every major dimension of rural economic life — agriculture, dairy, fisheries, horticulture, FPOs, Self-Help Groups (SHGs), Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs), credit, skills, infrastructure and entrepreneurship. These programmes remain fragmented. The challenge, therefore, is increasingly not the absence of programmatic interventions but that of an integrated ecosystem.

ECONOMIC OPPORTUNITIES

Clusters can provide a practical framework and bridge this gap by bringing together producer institutions, common infrastructure, finance, technology, skills and markets around specific economic opportunities. A dairy cluster, for instance, should extend beyond milk production to connect producers with breeding, feed, veterinary services, finance, processing, cold chains, branding and markets. A fisheries cluster should integrate production with credit, insurance, processing, logistics and market access. Cooperatives, FPOs and SHGs can serve as institutional anchors, while MSMEs,



A CHALLENGE. Developing an integrated ecosystem

banks, universities and technology providers can complete the ecosystem.

A recent field visit to Puri and Ganjam districts, Odisha made one point clear: the districts suffer from divided opportunity, not lack thereof. A dairy farmer receives veterinary support from one agency, feed from another, procurement through a cooperative, credit from a bank and insurance elsewhere. No single ecosystem connects these interventions into a competitive value chain. Processing has the same disconnect: machinery has been installed with public support, but some units operate at very low capacity because raw materials, markets, branding, logistics and enterprise capabilities have not kept pace.

In other words, the programme may perform, the asset may exist, but the enterprise may still be missing. The

imperative is to create the institutional and entrepreneurial ecosystem by connecting cooperatives, FPOs and SHGs with finance, skills, infrastructure, processing and markets to enable local producers and enterprises to capture that value.

The ambition should be to create rural economic growth clusters, not isolated production clusters. In such a model, cooperatives, FPOs, fisher collectives and SHGs become institutional anchors; aggregation creates scale; shared infrastructure enables value addition; finance and technology strengthen enterprise capability; and branding, logistics and digital markets connect producers to greater opportunities. In coastal Odisha, for instance, dairy, fisheries and horticulture could form the foundation of such integrated clusters, creating a pathway from local production to processing, enterprise creation and wider national and international markets.

Clusters can provide the institutional ecosystem needed to align skills with local opportunities, connect enterprises with finance and markets, and coordinate government, community institutions and private partners along a common development pathway from local production to global opportunity.

Dev is Chairman, and Tripathy is Joint Secretary, in the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister. Views are personal

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Planning reimagined

This refers to ‘A granular approach to growth and development’ (August 17). The need for adopting a granular, bottom-up approach to planning cannot be overemphasised. The standardised framework notified by the government to compile District Domestic Product estimates generates uniform data across districts, helps study regional disparities and allocate resources based on ground realities and enables more effective monitoring of the district level wealth generation

and growth. To fully harness the potential of the new framework, the existing District Planning Committees may be strengthened with technical expertise capable of analysing and interpreting the DDP data in conjunction with other granular, micro-level operational data and identifying growth opportunities.

Kosaraju Chandramouli
Hyderabad

5G network slicing

Apropos ‘Slicing it right’ (August 17),

the debate on 5G network slicing should also consider its potential to improve public infrastructure. Smart transport, telemedicine, disaster management and industrial automation require dependable connectivity, which ordinary networks may not always provide. Properly regulated slicing can create dedicated capacity for such critical applications. The priority, however, should remain public interest rather than commercial advantage. TRAI should identify essential services that deserve assured connectivity

and require operators to publish clear service standards. Independent monitoring can ensure that ordinary users are not disadvantaged.

Prajesh Paramasivan
Coimbatore

Energy security

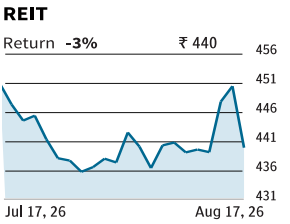
This refers to ‘India needs to build a dedicated strategic uranium reserve’ (August 17). India’s expanding nuclear programme requires a reliable and long-term fuel strategy. Dependence on overseas uranium supplies can expose energy planning

to geopolitical disruptions and price volatility. A strategic reserve would provide an important buffer, but it should be accompanied by greater domestic exploration, efficient mining and investment in reprocessing technologies. Long-term agreements with reliable suppliers can further strengthen energy security. Nuclear expansion must maintain stringent standards of safety, waste management and environmental protection.

SM Jeeva
Chennai

QUICKLY.

Bain Capital sells 5.64% stake in Embassy REIT



New Delhi: Global investment firm Bain Capital on Monday divested a 5.64 per cent unitholding in Embassy Office Parks REIT for ₹2,325 crore through open market transactions. US-based Bain Capital, through its affiliate APAC Company XXIII Ltd, sold a total of 5,34,51,142 unit in Bengaluru-based Embassy Office Parks REIT in the price range of ₹435.01-435.05 apiece, taking the combined deal size to ₹2,325.28 crore. Details of the buyers of Embassy REIT's units could not be ascertained on the exchange. Embassy Office Parks REIT's units fell nearly 3 per cent to close at ₹440.26 per unit on the NSE. **■**

Abakkus MF's asset base crosses ₹10,000 crore

Chennai: Abakkus Mutual Fund on Monday said that its assets under management crossed ₹10,000 crore, marking a significant milestone in its journey since the launch of its first scheme in December 2025. Founded by Sunil Singhania, Abakkus brings together deep market experience and a research-led approach to investing. Vaibhav Chugh, CEO, Abakkus Mutual Fund, said, "Our focus now is on expanding our reach, deepening our partner network and building a well-diversified product bouquet suited to varied investment needs." Abakkus Mutual Fund house has a total AUM of ₹10,056 crore as of August 13, 2026, with over 1.91 lakh investors across 2,006 locations and 12,741 pin codes. **OUR BUREAU**

Shares of Dhoot Transmission, Molbio end Day 1 on strong note

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Shares of Dhoot Transmission and Molbio Diagnostics made a strong stock market debut on Monday, with the former closing 36 per cent higher at ₹1,187.05 on the NSE against the IPO price of ₹871 while the latter closed around 29 per cent up at ₹1,041.70 (IPO price ₹807) on the NSE.

DHOOT TRANSMISSION

Bain Capital-backed Dhoot Transmission shares were listed at ₹1,200 on the NSE and rose further to ₹1,205. Ravi Singh, Chief Research Officer, Master Capital Services, emphasised Dhoot's strong position in wiring harnesses, including a 41 per cent share of India's combined two-wheeler and three-wheeler wiring harness market and nearly 70 per cent share in the electric version of that segment.

Singh said investors who received allotment may book partial profit at the listing

India Inc posts 'strongest PAT growth in 10 quarters' but markets stay in red

SUBDUED ACTIVITY. Lack of major domestic triggers and volatile crude keep benchmarks on sideways

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

India's corporate earnings recorded their best quarter in two-and-a-half years, according to the latest India Strategy report by Motilal Oswal Financial Services Ltd, yet the stock market stayed in the red.

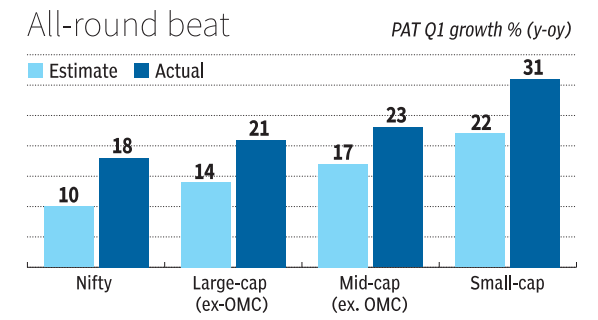
Weighed down by surging crude oil prices, geopolitical jitters and a weakening rupee, Indian benchmark indices extended their losing streak to a fifth straight session on Monday, even as the Q1-FY27 earnings season wrapped up with results well ahead of estimates.

The Nifty 50 settled at 24,287.65, down 78.35 points, while the Sensex slipped 0.36 per cent to close

at 77,728.16. The Nifty Mid-cap 100 ended nearly flat while the Nifty Smallcap 100 advanced 0.36 per cent, reflecting selective buying interest away from large-cap heavyweights.

Against this cautious backdrop, the Q1-FY27 earnings scorecard offered a rare bright spot. Nifty 50 companies reported 18 per cent y-o-y growth in profit after tax, the highest in 10 quarters and well ahead of Motilal Oswal's 10 per cent estimate.

ONGC, Hindalco, Reliance Industries, JSW Steel and Bharti Airtel collectively accounted for 60 per cent of the earnings increase. Mid-cap and small-cap companies also impressed, with PAT rising 23 per cent and 31 per cent respectively. The FY27 Nifty EPS estimate has since



Source: Motilal Oswal Financial

been nudged up 0.6 per cent to ₹1,232.

SMALL-CAPS SIZZLE

"Small-caps (186 companies) outperformed significantly, delivering strong earnings growth of 31 per cent y-o-y (vs estimates of 22 per cent), supported by a favourable base (vs a 1 per cent y-

o-y rise in Q1-FY26) and driven primarily by Financials and Oil & Gas."

Ajit Mishra, SVP, Research, Religare Broking, said investor sentiment remained subdued as Brent crude moved towards the \$90 per barrel mark amid continued uncertainty surrounding the US-Iran con-

flict and concerns over potential disruptions to global energy supplies. The lack of major domestic triggers following the completion of the earnings season also kept participants cautious.

Nifty Realty gained 1.46 per cent and Nifty Metal climbed 1.26 per cent, with Hindalco and Tata Steel among the top index gainers. On the other end, IT shed 1.75 per cent and FMCG fell 1.05 per cent, with HCL Technologies and Infosys leading the declines.

Looking ahead, markets are likely to remain range-bound this week with focus shifting firmly to global cues. The US Fed's July FOMC minutes, the trajectory of crude prices and the status of the US-Iran ceasefire will be the primary watch points.

Resilient Asset to sell up to 5% stake in Paytm

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Resilient Asset Management BV is set to offload up to a 4.98 per cent stake in One 97 Communications (Paytm) through a block deal on stock exchanges. The transaction has a base offer size of 1.92 crore shares (3 per cent stake) valued at approximately ₹2,949 crore, with an option to upsze by another 1.27 crore shares (1.98 per cent stake) worth around ₹1,946 crore.

The floor price for the sale has been fixed at ₹1,535.10 a share, a discount of about 2.9 per cent to the closing price of ₹1,580.20 on the NSE.

REIT quarterly distributions cross ₹3,000 crore in Q1

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

Listed real estate investment trusts (REITs) distributed ₹3,136 crore to unitholders in the first quarter of FY27, more than double the ₹1,559 crore distributed in the year-ago quarter, as the sector expanded to six listed trusts from four a year earlier.

The sharp year-on-year increase, however, also reflects the addition of Knowledge Realty Trust and Bagmane Prime Office REIT to the listed universe. The four REITs that were listed in both periods were Embassy Office Parks REIT, Mindspace Business Parks REIT, Brookfield India Real Estate Trust and Nexus Select Trust.

REITs are mandated by the regulator to distribute 90 per cent of their net distributable cash flow (NDCF).

DISTRIBUTION GROWTH

Distributions rose steadily from ₹1,371 crore in Q1 FY25 to ₹1,553 crore in Q1 FY25. They were ₹1,559 crore in Q1 FY26, before jumping nearly 50 per cent to ₹2,331 crore in Q2 following the addition of Knowledge Realty Trust to the listed universe.

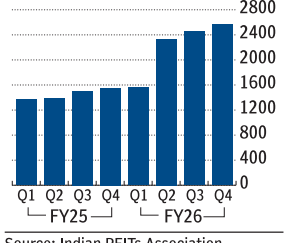
Distributions rose further to ₹2,450 crore in Q3 and ₹2,566 crore in Q4, before rising 22 per cent to ₹3,136 crore in Q1 FY27 on the addition of Bagmane Prime Office REIT in the latest quarter. Across the six listed REITs, cumulative distributions since inception have crossed ₹34,800 crore.

The trusts together manage more than 214 million sq ft of Grade A office and retail space, with gross AUM of over ₹3.17 lakh crore as of Q1 FY27.

HEALTHY COLLECTIONS

"The strong distribution in the quarter, despite contin-

Rising payouts from REITs (in ₹ cr)



Source: Indian REITs Association

Stronger leasing, occupancy and portfolio additions support distribution growth; six listed REITs have now crossed ₹34,800 crore in cumulative payouts

ued global uncertainties, is a positive start to the financial year," said Shishir Godbole, CEO of Knowledge Realty Trust and chairperson of the Indian REITs Association.

He said the growth was supported by "healthy rental collections, improving occupancy, the quality of the underlying assets and disciplined capital management by REIT managers".

Mindspace REIT CEO and MD Ramesh Nair said the trust had recorded seven consecutive quarters of in distributions.

"This performance has been supported by robust leasing and occupancy growth in our core markets, along with acquisitions that enhance portfolio scale. In addition, new growth avenues such as data centres, hotels and clubs are contributing to the evolution of our portfolio."

The six REITs had a combined market capitalisation of over ₹2.17 lakh crore as of August 11, according to the Indian REITs Association.

BROKER'S CALL.

Axis Securities

ENDURANCE TECH (BUY)

Target: ₹3,255
CMP: ₹2,981.15
Endurance Technologies continues to strengthen its manufacturing capabilities through targeted capacity additions. In braking systems, the company is adding about 0.9 million ABS capacity to its existing 0.64 million units, with SOP expected by September/October 2026, while new dual-channel ABS programmes for Bajaj Auto are scheduled to commence in Q1/Q3FY27. The new Chennai disc brake facility, with a capacity of about 3 million assemblies, is expected to commence supplies to Royal Enfield in September 2026, with other OEMs following in Q3FY27.

In suspension, the management targets monthly inverted fork capacity of about one lakh units by FY27, while new programmes with Bajaj Auto, Hero MotoCorp and Suzuki are expected to ramp up from Q3FY27. The company is also scaling its four-wheeler aluminium casting business, with cumulative bookings of about ₹513 crore per annum at Shendra. The company is steadily strengthening its presence across the EV value chain through battery packs, BMS, motor controllers, DC-DC converters and aluminium castings. The battery pack plant near Pune commenced SOP for Hero MotoCorp in June and is expected to reach peak volumes by Q3FY27, with the company also investing ₹62 crore to enter four-wheeler battery packs, with SOP targeted for Q4FY27. We maintain our Buy rating on Endurance Technologies, led by strong order visibility, EV traction and upcoming capacities supporting medium-term growth momentum.

ICICI Securities

HG INFRA ENGINEERING (HOLD)

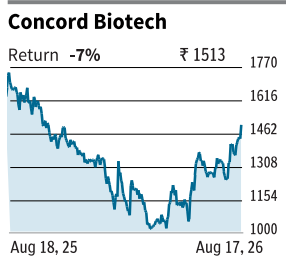
Target: ₹535
CMP: ₹514.90
HG Infra reported a weak quarter, with revenue shrinking 47 per cent year on year to ₹900 crore on account of delays in appointed dates, supply chain issues and project specific hurdles. EBITDA declined 67 per cent to ₹77 crore, as margins shrank 530 bps to 8.5 per cent. Adj. loss stood at ₹1.8 crore vs APAT of ₹130 crore. It has booked a one-off profit of ₹30.1 crore on account of sale of three HAM assets. The company's order-book stands at ₹14,500 crore vs ₹14,700 crore year on year, driven by strong inflows from the highway sector during the quarter. However, executable order-book stands at just ₹8,000 crore, owing to land acquisition delays and project level hurdles, according to the management. On a positive side, it has won new orders worth ₹5,300 crore in Q1. The widening gap between order-book and execution remains a key monitorable on account of delays in several projects. The management has trimmed its FY27 guidance of revenues to ₹6,000-6,500 crore, from earlier ₹7,000 crore, citing slower execution ramp-up while maintaining margin guidance at 13.5-14 per cent and order inflow guidance firm at ₹1,000-12,000 crore. However, we are baking in a slower pace of execution than the guidance implies, basis execution risk on the back of a smaller executable order-book. We maintain Hold with an SoTP-based revised TP of ₹535 (earlier ₹610).

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Concord Biotech (₹1,513.40): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau



The short-term outlook is bullish for Concord Biotech. The stock began the week on a strong note, rising 4.2 per cent on Monday. This has taken the share price well above ₹1,480, a key resistance level. It also indicates that the stock has resumed its broader uptrend after a brief pause for a week.

Moving average crossovers on the daily chart also strengthen the bullish case. Concord Biotech share price can rise to ₹1,730 in the coming weeks.

Traders can buy Concord Biotech shares now at ₹1,513. Accumulate on dips at ₹1,495.

Keep the stop-loss at ₹1,410. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹1,545 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹1,590. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹1,585 and ₹1,645 when the price touches ₹1,630 and ₹1,690, respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹1,710.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24371 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
24340	24290	24460	24530	Go short on a break below 24340 with a stop-loss at 24370

₹731 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
726	723	737	742	Go long now and at 728. Keep the stop-loss at 725

₹1137 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1115	1090	1145	1160	Go short now and at 1043. Keep the stop-loss at 1155

₹273 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
272	268	275	278	Go short on a rise at 274. Stop-loss can be kept at 276

₹239 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
241	243	237	235	Can go either way from here. Avoid trading the stock

₹1320 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1310	1300	1340	1350	Go long now and at 1315. Keep the stop-loss at 1305

₹1065 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1055	1050	1070	1090	Go long only above 1070. Stop-loss can be kept at 1065

₹2314 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2285	2265	2330	2345	Go short now and on a rise at 2325. Keep the stop-loss at 2340

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Voltas slides 4% as Q1 results get mixed reactions from analysts

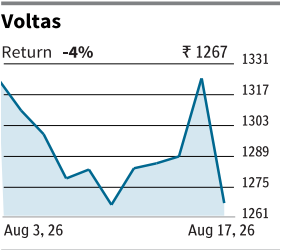
Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Voltas shares reversed early gains and settled 4 per cent lower at ₹1,267 on the NSE on Monday after brokerages gave mixed reactions to the company's Q1-FY27 results.

Voltas reported a 51.3 per cent increase in consolidated net profit to ₹212.76 crore in the first quarter, led by a strong performance in the room air conditioners segment.

The company said it has increased market share, and margins have improved and expects Q2 to be better.

Citi retained a 'Buy' rating on Voltas with a target price of ₹1,550. It said RAC volume grew 45 per cent y-o-y, twice the industry growth, leading to a 17.3 per cent secondary market share



for YTD June FY27. The market share lead over the nearest competitor was 4 percentage points, while margins remained subdued at 5.3 per cent, up 168 basis points y-o-y.

Voltas has also signed a JV agreement with Atomberg Innovation to develop and manufacture high-efficiency RAC compressors in India, with capacity of 2.8mn units. Commercial production is expected in 18 months.

UBS retained a 'Buy' rating with a target price of

₹1,560. Voltas' JV with Atomberg is targeting capacity of 2.8 million units. In Voltas Beko, FY27 EBITDA break-even may slip by a few quarters due to commodity inflation, it said.

CAUTIOUS TONE

CLSA retained its 'Underperform' rating on Voltas with a target price of ₹1,160. It said margins were low despite strong volume growth and price increases.

Nomura, while retaining a 'Neutral' rating with a target price of ₹1,357, said high competition would delay margin recovery. The brokerage said the focus on market share over profitability would keep margin recovery slower, while compressor JV localisation execution would remain a key monitorable for meaningful benefits over the longer term.

Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 78.35 pts.					
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Reliance Ind	1316.00	8.86	20.20	8.00	
L&T	4086.70	7.60	28.65	4.30	
HDFC Bank	729.00	6.69	13.61	10.04	
Hindalco	1049.90	6.45	14.39	1.37	
Axis Bank	1227.30	6.21	13.66	3.17	
Tata Steel	186.00	4.52	20.61	1.38	
Kotak Bank	392.70	2.49	19.24	2.60	
ONGC	238.49	1.77	6.70	0.88	
HDFC Life	543.00	1.68	59.33	0.53	
JSW Steel	1277.80	1.60	11.16	1.08	
UltraTech Cement	11681.00	1.60	40.16	1.24	
Bajaj Finance	1089.30	1.35	32.85	2.63	
Bharat Elec	412.45	1.29	49.04	1.33	
Titan	5068.50	1.11	78.12	1.88	
Coal India	408.45	0.71	8.10	0.88	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	249.75	0.50	79.80	0.74	
Grasim Ind	3250.50	0.15	19.44	1.10	
PowerGrid Corp	266.15	0.10	15.57	1.08	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1122.00	0.00	23.32	1.41	
Bajaj Finserv	2005.00	-0.42	15.55	1.04	
SBI Life	1790.40	-0.45	69.06	0.72	
Eicher Motors	8050.00	-0.50	38.28	1.00	
Eternal Ltd.	318.00	-0.79	708.73	2.07	
Max Healthcare	1003.70	-0.80	67.03	0.67	
Asian Paints	2687.50	-0.87	53.29	1.09	
Bajaj Auto	11663.00	-0.90	28.22	1.16	
Tata Consumer/Product	1077.60	-0.98	64.64	0.63	
Rajdix Lab	1192.00	-1.07	31.25	0.65	
Wipro	181.90	-1.24	13.56	0.44	
Adani Ports	1691.00	-1.45	29.69	1.12	
IntiglobeAvi	5275.50	-1.71	0.00	1.07	
Adani Enter	3007.30	-1.75	52.07	0.78	
Tata Motors PV	336.20	-1.96	0.00	0.82	
Maruti Suzuki	13760.00	-2.11	30.16	1.62	
Apollo Hosp	8825.50	-2.14	58.42	0.82	
Cipla	1431.50	-2.27	34.46	0.72	
Trent Ltd.	2946.00	-2.33	86.57	0.88	
ICICI Bank	1415.30	-2.66	16.99	1.12	
NTPC	337.00	-3.11	11.53	1.44	
Tech Mahindra	1610.00	-3.18	30.56	0.92	
Hind Unilever	2055.00	-4.27	46.01	1.64	
NestleIndia	1470.00	-4.56	74.38	0.95	
State Bank	1061.20	-5.87	10.92	3.95	
M&M	3390.40	-7.39	20.83	2.72	
HCL Tech	1325.00	-8.06	20.62	1.26	
TCS	2313.20	-10.66	16.72	1.12	
ITC	273.05	-10.85	16.36	2.37	
Sun Pharma	1882.00	-11.11	37.27	1.79	
Bharti Airtel	1969.30	-15.15	32.95	5.39	
Infosys	1139.90	-22.46	15.25	3.60	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers ▼ 12.45 pts.					
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Tvs Motor Cmp .	4385.90	53.86	57.86	4.02	

QUICKLY.

Galilei Holdings to invest in Ice Make Refrigeration

Mumbai: Ice Make Refrigeration said Japanese firm Galilei Holdings will invest ₹180 crore in the company to fund its capacity expansion and modernisation projects. Galilei will invest ₹180 crore in Ice Make through a preferential issue of equity shares, while Ice Make will raise a further ₹10 crore from other investors, a company statement said. The companies also proposed a 60:40 joint venture, with Galilei holding 60 per cent and Ice Make holding 40 per cent, the statement said. **m**

SkyHop, NOEMI ink pact for electric seaplane ops

Mumbai: Seaplane operator SkyHop Aviation on Monday said it has signed an initial pact with Norwegian aviation firm NOEMI Aerospace to explore the deployment of electric seaplanes in India and the wider South Asian region as part of the company's plans to build the country's next generation of regional air connectivity. SkyHop plans to induct up to 10 NOEMI aircraft by FY30 through purchase, lease or a combination of both, subject to commercial evaluation and the execution of definitive agreements. **m**

‘MSME Development (Amendment) Bill can be an IBC moment for MSMEs’

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026, if executed well, can be an IBC (Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code) moment for MSMEs, bringing similar discipline to one of the most persistent challenges facing them — delayed payments, according to a Crisil Intelligence (CI) report.

As of August 14, data from MSME Samadhaan show micro and small enterprises filed 2,56,892 applications involving delayed payments worth ₹55,244 crore, of which claims amounting to ₹20,979 crore remain pending, the report said.

Further, around 40,580 applications (16 per cent) have remained unresolved for over a year, highlighting the scale of working capital locked in delayed or disputed receivables. CI officials emphasised that given many MSMEs do not formally report payment delays, the actual figure could be significantly higher.

CI noted that under the existing framework (Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development/MSMED Act), dispute resolution through Micro and Small Enterprises Facilitation Councils (MSEFCs) lacked clearly-defined

FCNR(B) inflows stabilise rupee but fail to trigger 2013-style rally

LESS IMPACT. They strengthen RBI’s ability to defend the currency, but not enough to change its direction

Mahesh Ravidas Nayak
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India’s FCNR(B) deposit mobilisation scheme has attracted more than \$52 billion so far and could have crossed \$80 billion, including related foreign currency borrowings, had the window remained open until the original September-end deadline.

Yet, unlike the 2013 FCNR (B) programme, the rupee failed to stage a meaningful appreciation, highlighting the influence of global monetary conditions over exchange-rate movements.

The contrast with 2013 is striking. The earlier FCNR (B) scheme, launched between September 4 and November 30, 2013, helped restore confidence following the taper tantrum. The rupee appreciated from 65.7 per dollar at August-end 2013 to 62.45 by November-end, a gain of 4.9 per cent, and strengthened further to 59.89 by March 2014, reflecting an overall appreciation of 8.8 per cent, according to SBI Research.

Contrasting tales

Period	USD INR	% of appreciation(+) / depreciation(-)
FCNR(B) Swap in 2013		
Aug 31, 2013	65.7	
Oct 23, 2013	61.59	6.30
Nov 6, 2013	62.4	-1.30
Nov 11, 2013	63.24	-1.30
Nov 20, 2013	62.58	1.00
Nov 30, 2013	62.45	0.20
Nov 30, 2013 (Cumulative)	62.45	4.90
Mar 28, 2014 (Cumulative)	59.89	8.80
FCNR(B) Swap in 2026		
Jun 8, 2026	95.71	
Jul 17, 2026	96.28	-0.60
Jul 31, 2026	95.39	0.90
Aug 13, 2026	95.42	0.00
Aug 17, 2026 (Cumulative)	95.6	0.10

Source: SBI Research

This time, however, the currency barely moved, despite the much larger inflows. The rupee was at 95.71 per dollar on June 8, when the latest FCNR(B) window opened and was around 95.60 on August 17, implying a cumulative appreciation of just 0.1 per cent.

“The impact on rupee post the announcement of FCNR (B) measures has been surprisingly minimal,” said Soumya Kanti Ghosh, Group Chief Economic Adviser at State Bank of India, in its report. He noted that while the magnitude of the appreciation may differ from 2013

due to vastly different macroeconomic conditions, the direction of the impact should ideally have been supportive of the currency.

GLOBAL CONDITIONS

Economists said the muted response reflects a much tougher global backdrop than in 2013. “You can’t expect the rupee to appreciate merely because of FCNR(B) inflows,” said Gaura Sengupta, Chief Economist at IDFC First Bank.

Sengupta said a balance-of-payments surplus did not automatically translate into currency appreciation, particularly when global interest rates remain elevated. Much of the FCNR(B) money is being absorbed through RBI swap facilities, allowing the central bank to defend the currency rather than push it higher. Without the FCNR(B) inflows and RBI intervention, the rupee would likely have weakened much more sharply.

According to her, the world is currently grappling with high inflation, elevated debt levels and tighter monetary policy, unlike the

period following the taper tantrum when abundant liquidity and easing fears around US policy tightening helped emerging-market currencies recover. “The FCNR(B) has helped stabilise the currency and limit depreciation pressure, but it cannot negate it,” she added.

The RBI’s decision to close the FCNR(B) window a month early suggests that it may already have achieved its mobilisation target. Sengupta said keeping the facility open could have led to significantly larger inflows, creating repayment risks three to five years later when the deposits mature. The swaps, used to absorb inflows, also inject rupee liquidity into the banking system, adding to liquidity management challenges.

Going forward, economists expect inflows to continue supporting the rupee by boosting the RBI’s intervention capacity and foreign exchange reserves. The latest FCNR(B) scheme has strengthened the RBI’s ability to defend the currency, but it has not been enough to change its direction.

Rupee declines to a two-week low on early closure of swap facility

Our Bureau
Mumbai



The rupee on Monday declined and closed at a two-week low, with the trading sentiment in the forex market being weighed down by the early closure of the RBI’s concessional swap facility for attracting fresh Foreign Currency Non-Resident-Bank (FCNR-B) deposits and importer demand for dollars.

The rupee closed at 95.60 per dollar, down 18 paise over the previous close of 95.42. Intra-day, the rupee tested a high/low of 95.48/95.62. Traders indicated that the RBI was present in the market, stabilising the rupee through dollar sales.

The RBI said the concessional swap facility will now be available only for FCNR-B deposits of three-five years maturity mobilised till August 31, 2026, against the earlier deadline of September 30. Correspondingly, the swaps under this facility may be availed by banks with the RBI till September 11, against October 16 earlier.

EARLY CLOSURE

Soumya Kanti Ghosh, Group Chief Economic Advisor, SBI, said while there may be valid reasons to justify an

early closure, the most likely reason could be that the target for FCNR(B) mobilisation had already been achieved, with inflows at \$57 billion.

“We don’t believe that the cost of swap could have been a constraining factor. Our estimates show that the cumulative cost would amount to around 15 per cent of the corpus, or \$10.5 billion.”

He added that while this appears sizeable in absolute terms, “it needs to be viewed against the scale of India’s foreign-exchange reserves rather than the FCNR(B) corpus alone.”

SBI’s Economic Research Department estimated that with current forex reserves of around \$700 billion and incremental reserve accumulation assumed at roughly \$20 billion annually, the five-year cumulative hedging cost of \$10.5 billion would amount to only 1.45 per cent of the current reserve stock and around 1.27 per cent of the projected reserve stock.

Baazar Style zooms 5% as Halwasiya buys 45 lakh shares

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Shares of Baazar Style Retail hit the 5 per cent upper circuit at ₹384, as Aditya Halwasiya acquired 45 lakh shares worth ₹163 crore in a block deal.

The investment comes at an important inflection point for Style Baazar, with an ambition to rapidly expand its network to a minimum of 500 stores in three years.

The entry of Halwasiya, alongside the strategic investment already made by Cupid Ltd through warrants, represents about 12 per cent of the company on conversion. Of these warrants, about 3 per cent have already been exercised into equity shares. This has created a formidable new shareholder presence around the business and adds another dimension to Baazar Style’s next phase of growth.

Equally significant is the huge commercial potential for Cupid’s rapidly-expanding consumer product portfolio, with Baazar Style’s growing retail footprint capable of providing a powerful platform for the sale, visibility and penetration of Cupid products across a large and growing consumer base.

Razorpay enhances AI capabilities with a payments model trained on 4 b transactions

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

Razorpay has built an AI payments foundation model trained on four billion transactions, seeking to improve payment success rates, fraud detection and checkout personalisation as India’s digital payments ecosystem scales.

The model, built with Nvidia and AWS, uses around 3,000 signals per transaction and is designed to analyse payment flows across merchants, banks, instruments and gateways.

Razorpay said early tests across 1.5 million transactions and more than 51,000 businesses showed an 8-10 per cent improvement in payment success rates, an eight-fold increase in international card fraud detection and a five-fold increase in identification of fraudulent



Harshil Mathur, Co-founder and CEO, Razorpay

or disputed transactions.

“The payment foundation model is one single foundational model that works for all of these things. So it is multi-dimensional in nature,” Harshil Mathur, Co-founder and CEO of Razorpay, said.

Unlike traditional machine-learning models built for individual use-cases such as fraud or payment success, the foundation model is de-

signed to learn from the entire payments ecosystem and extend to new use-cases.

PAYMENT MODEL

Mathur said the model had been tested, with some merchants routing up to 50-60 per cent of their payment volumes through it. At Blinkit, the model had delivered a one-two percentage point improvement in payment success rates, he said.

“And we’re the first ones in India,” Mathur said, adding that payment foundation models built in other markets cannot simply be deployed in India because the country’s payment architecture, including UPI, cards, net banking and its diverse banking ecosystem, is different.

The company is currently not charging merchants separately for the model. Mathur said Razorpay expects

to monetise the technology initially through increased payment volumes and additional services, including potential applications in lending and marketing.

Razorpay said the model is built and operated within India, with personally identifiable information removed before data is fed into the system.

Mathur said the company has also put guardrails in place, including maintaining existing false-positive rates for fraud detection.

The company sees the foundation model as part of a broader strategy to combine AI with financial services.

“Razorpay’s goal is to combine AI with financial services for businesses that we power,” Mathur said.

The company plans to eventually use the model across authentication, routing, fraud and lending.

Star Health expects Home Health Care initiative to grow over 50 per cent in the next one year

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

India’s largest standalone retail health insurer Star Health and Allied Insurance expects its Home Health Care (HHC) initiative to grow at least 50 per cent in utilisation in the next year as this segment is witnessing significant traction.

The HHC segment, launched in 2024, provides prompt medical care to customers at their homes, enhancing accessibility and convenience, making it customer-centric. This segment recorded around 600 per cent year-on-year growth in terms of customers in the first quarter of this fiscal.

GOOD RESPONSE

“We have had a very good response to this service, which is a completely cashless arrangement. In terms of absolute number, we could deliver close to 50,000 consults under the HHC programme in the first quarter of the cur-



Overall technology, the number of doctors’ availability, the level of service have increased

AMITABH JAIN
Chief Operating Officer, Star Health and Allied Insurance

rent financial year. The access and availability itself have been increased,” Star Health and Allied Insurance Chief Operating Officer Amitabh Jain told *businessline*.

HHC offers at-home treat-

ment for fever, infectious diseases, gastritis and urinary tract infections, among others, enabling early treatment and reducing avoidable hospital visits.

“Last year, around this time, we were in less than 200 cities under this programme. Now it’s available in 300 cities. Overall technology, the number of doctors’ availability, the level of service have increased. We have actively marketed this with our distribution to reach out to our end-customers,” Jain said. Further expansion would depend on the availability of partners, who are specialist vendors, nurses, critical medical equipment and medicines.

MARKET SHARE

Going forward, the health insurer aims to expand HHC to tier-2 and tier-3 cities, strengthen digital capabilities and enhance healthcare partnerships to bring quality care closer to customers.

Star Health’s retail market share was 29 per cent in Q1

FY27 compared to 31 per cent in Q1 FY26, partly impacted by a share of long-term policies and consequent reporting implications on an N and 1/N basis. More than 95 per cent of its premium income currently comes from retail insurance. In the first quarter this fiscal, its retail health insurance premium grew around 19 per cent.

“It is a conscious strategy to stay away from a particular segment of group insurance, which is the large corporates and the medium-size companies. We don’t find that there is viability in doing that business, because typically that business runs on a loss. In the SME segment, we find that it works, and that is the space where we are operating in,” Jain said.

On the distribution front, the two biggest distribution channels from the fresh customer acquisitions’ point of view are agents and digital. Overall, around 90 per cent of the insurer’s premium income comes from the agency channel.

NATURAL CAPSULES LIMITED
CIN NO. L85110KA1993PLC014742
Reg. office: No.23, Trident Towers, 4th Floor, 100 Feet Road, Jayanagar 2nd Block, Bangalore-560011
Website: www.naturalcapsules.com
E-mail:info@naturalcapsules.com, Contact:080-26561562

NOTICE OF EXTRAORDINARY GENERAL MEETING TO BE HELD THROUGH VIDEO CONFERENCING (VC) OTHER AUDIO-VISUAL MEANS (OAVM)

Notice is hereby given that Extraordinary General Meeting ("EGM") of the members of Natural Capsules Limited will be held on Wednesday, September 09, 2026 at 12:00 PM through Video Conferencing ("VC")/Other Audio Visual Means ("OAVM") facility as per the provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and rules made thereunder ("The Act") read with General Circular Nos 20/2020, 09/2023 and 09/2024 dated May 05, 2020, September 25, 2023 and September 19, 2024, respectively and other circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (collectively "MCA Circulars"), without physical presence of the members at a common venue. The deemed venue for the EGM shall be registered office of the Company.

In compliance with the relevant circulars, the Notice of EGM, will be sent only by email to all the members of the Company, whose email address are registered With the Company/ Depository Participants ("DP"). The same will be available on the Company's website www.naturalcapsules.com, website of stock exchange(s), i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and NSDL (agency for providing the Remote e-Voting facility) at www.evoting.nsdl.com. The Company will also be sending communication providing the web-link, including the exact path of the Notice, to those members whose e-mail address is not registered with the Company/DP. Members can join and participate in the EGM through VC/OAVM facility only. The Instructions for Joining the EGM and the manner of participation in the remote e-voting or cast vote through e-voting system during the EGM will be provided in the Notice of EGM. Members participating in the EGM through VC/OAVM facility shall be counted for the purpose of reckoning the quorum under Section 103 of the Act.

Members holding shares in physical mode, who have not registered their email address with the Company/RTA are requested to register the same by submitting duly filled in Form ISR-1 along with the supporting documents to RTA at investors@cameoindia.com and company.sec@naturalcapsules.com. Form ISR-1 can be downloaded from the Company's website at www.naturalcapsules.com as well as from RTA website. Members holding shares in Dematerialized form are requested to update their email address with their Depository Participants. Members are requested to contact Ms. Gomathi C of Cameo Corporate Services Limited, our Registrar and Share Transfer Agents for any grievances related to e-voting by writing to them on gomathi@cameoindia.com or calling them on 044-40020728 between 10:00 AM to 05:00 PM.

The above information is being issued for the benefit of all members of the Company and is in compliance with the Act and MCA Circulars.

For Natural Capsules Limited
Sd/-
Akshay Dutta
Company Secretary

Place: Bangalore
Date: August 18, 2026

COCHIN INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LTD.

CIAL/ELE/417A TENDER NOTICE 18.08.2026

Sealed Item Rate E-tenders are invited for the below - mentioned work from the reputed electrical contractors having credentials as specified below. The cost of the tender document is Rs.2000/- + GST.

Sl No.	Name of Work	Estimated Amount (Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)	Completion Period
1	SITC of DC Fast Charging Stations for EV Passenger Coaches at Cochin International Airport	Rs.31.77 Lakhs	Rs.80,000/-	04 Months

For further details visit the website <https://www.cial.aero/tenders>
Interested agencies may register themselves on the online E-Tendering portal <https://etenders.kerala.gov.in> and download the tender documents from **19.08.2026**.
Sd/- Managing Director

MAITHON POWER LIMITED
(Contracts Department)
Maithon Power Ltd, Village: Dambhui, PO Barindia, PIN-828205, District-Dhanbad

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Maithon Power Limited, a joint venture between Tata Power and DVC invites expression of interest from eligible vendors for the following packages:

S.No.	Ref.No	Package Description
1	1000079823	Long term rate contract for as & when supply of Gaskets, Ropes, and Gland Packing for three years.
2	2000096896	AMC of ICT infra support 24X7 for MPL Plant, WB, Guest House and Township for 3 Years

For details of pre-qualification requirements, bid security, purchasing of tender document etc., please visit our website URL- <https://www.tatapower.com/tender>
Eligible vendors willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee for issue of bid document latest by **31st Aug'26**.

KLM AXIVA FINVEST LIMITED				
Registered Office: Plot No. 39, Door No. 813, 1st Floor, Ashoka Complex, Mythenrajan Colony, Guayathi Nagar X Road, Chennai - 600 096. CIN: U69101TG1997PLC206983 www.klm-axiva.com				
				(Rs. In Lakhs)
Sl.No.	Particulars	Quarter ending June 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ending June 30, 2025 (Unaudited)	Previous year ended on March 31, 2026 (Audited)
1	Total Income from Operations	9,906.72	8,223.78	24,118.77
2	Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items *)	241.93	108.89	913.09
3	Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items *)	241.93	108.89	913.09
4	Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)/Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary Items	241.93	108.89	886.08
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax))	241.93	108.89	822.10
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital	26,858.14	26,858.14	26,858.14
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	-5,688.24	1,624.29	-3,930.17
8	Net worth	21,169.90	28,482.43	20,927.97
9	Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt	1,59,337.23	1,58,202.65	1,56,462.44
10	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	Nil	Nil	Nil
11	Debt Equity Ratio	7.53	5.56	7.48
12	Earnings Per Share (Rs.)			
12.1	Basic:	0.09	0.04	0.33
12.2	Diluted:	0.09	0.04	0.33
13	Capital Redemption Reserve	Nil	Nil	Nil
14	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil	Nil	Nil
15	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	0.07	0.09	0.34
16	Interest Service Coverage Ratio	1.05	1.02	1.05

*The financial ratios being computed based on figures reported up to June 30, 2026.

**The financial ratios being computed based on figures reported up to June 30, 2026.

Sl.No.	Particulars	Quarter ended June 30, 2026
1	Net equity ratio	7.53
2	Net service coverage ratio	0.07
3	Interest coverage ratio	1.05
4	Outstanding redeemable preference shares	Nil
5	Capital redemption reserve/Debitum	Nil
6	Net worth (incl. revaluation reserve) for the year	21,169.90 Lakhs
7	Net profit/ (loss) after tax for the quarter ended	241.93 Lakhs
8	Current Ratio (Base & Dividend)	0.09
9	Current Ratio	0.09
10	Long term debt to working capital	7.53
11	Debt ratio to account receivable ratio	0.09
12	Current liability ratio	0.37
13	Debt ratio to total assets	0.09
14	Debt to Equity Ratio	7.53
15	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
16	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
17	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
18	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
19	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
20	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
21	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
22	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
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94	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
95	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
96	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
97	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
98	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
99	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil
100	Debitum Redemption Reserve	Nil

a) The above is an extract of the detailed form of quarterly/ annual financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 52 of the LODR Regulations. The full form of the quarterly/ annual financial results is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges (see website) and the listed entity (<https://www.klm-axiva.com>)

b) The financial ratios presented being computed based on figures reported up to June 30, 2026

For KLM AXIVA FINVEST LIMITED

Shrii Theerapornpattong Vorngvong

Whole time Director

025/2997991

For KLM AXIVA FINVEST LIMITED

Place: Ernakulam



New Delhi: Nelco, a Tata Group satellite communication service provider, on Monday announced a partnership and an investment of \$20 million in US-based Lunar Holdco Inc, which operates as Elveo Mobile. The investment is aimed at bringing next-generation direct-to-device and Internet of Things satellite connectivity to India and South Asian markets, said the company in a regulatory filing. ■

The Hindu Bureau
New Delhi

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi



Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai



Vinod Sahay, President,
Trucks & Buses, and Executive
Chairman, SML Mahindra

The combined network has about 200 dealers and 650 touchpoints. Mahindra plans to add 20-25 dealerships and 50-60 service stations over the next 18 months.

bl.interview

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Edited excerpts:

66

At Julius Baer, we are exploring how AI can support both clients and employees and streamline day-to-day activities

RAHUL MALHOTRA
Region Head, Emerging
Markets, and Member of
GWMC at Julius Baer



Direct investments and pre-IPOs can certainly have a place in a portfolio, but investors need to size these bets appropriately and understand that they could lose their entire capital. The key is to approach such investments with your eyes wide open and allocate only a portion of the portfolio that you are comfortable putting at risk.

Many HNIs have created substantial wealth through real estate and equities.

We are seeing greater interest in fixed income, REITs, INVITs, structured products and alternative investments. At the same time, clients want greater access to global markets, and are looking to diversify their wealth offshore. Global diversification is, therefore, an important theme for us. Resident Indians increasingly want to invest overseas, while NRIs continue to look at investment opportunities in India.

The belief that Indian markets would continuously deliver 15-25 per cent returns has not been borne out. The current environment is encouraging investors to construct portfolios in a much more balanced manner.

Our Bureau
Chennai

Speaking to *businessline*, Priyansh Mohan, Co-founder & CEO, Meine Electric, said the pilot project will

The project will be implemented alongside the Atal

The study is expected to generate operational data and insights into the suitability of the technology for long-duration energy stor-

CES VALIDATION

Its proprietary fast charge long discharge (FCLD) technology, which enables a six-hour charge and 18-hour discharge, has also been independently validated by Customised Energy Solutions (CES), the parent com-

Mohan said about 70 per cent of the companies Meind Electric is in talks with are private utilities and independent power producers while the rest are government firms.

QUICKLY.

Crude oil edges higher as W. Asia conflict talks stall



Oil prices rose on Monday on a lack of progress in diplomatic efforts to resolve the West Asia conflict, though the absence of major supply outages limited gains. Brent crude futures were up 34 cents, or 0.38 per cent, at \$88.86 a barrel by 1202 GMT after hitting a session high of \$89.68. US West Texas Intermediate crude futures rose 4 cents or 0.05 per cent to \$82.44 a barrel. **REUTERS**

Copper hits six-month peak on low inventories

London: Copper prices hit their highest in more than six months on Monday due to worries about availability on the London Metal Exchange, where inventories are at their lowest since February. Benchmark copper traded up 1.1 per cent at \$14,310 a tonne in official rings from an earlier high at \$13,396. **REUTERS**

Soybean oil imports set for a record in August

Mumbai: Soybean oil imports are set to hit a record high in August as competitive prices prompt refiners to boost purchases for festival season demand, while disruptions to sunflower oil shipments due to the Russia-Ukraine war push buyers to switch oils, dealers said. Soybean oil imports in August are likely to rise to 6,20,000 tonnes, nearly 46 per cent above the average monthly imports of 4,24,549 tonnes so far in the current marketing year, which began in November, according to traders. **REUTERS**

Pulses imports down a tad during H1 this year

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Pulses imports were a tad lower in the first six months of calendar 2026 at 31.8 lakh tonnes, down 1.46 per cent from 32.27 lakh tonnes a year ago, on a dip in chana (chick-pea) and urad (black matpe) imports.

However, imports of tur (pigeon peas), masoor (lentils) and yellow peas were up during this period, according to a recent market update by trade body India Pulses and Grains Association (IPGA), which quoted DGCIS figures.

SUPPLY SHIFT

Tur imports were up 43.34 per cent during this period at over 5.05 lakh tonnes, with the bulk of the supplies coming from African producers such as Mozambique, Tanzania and Sudan, among others.

Mozambique was the largest supplier of tur during

Kharif crop area 21 lakh hectares lower than a year ago as pace of sowing slows

GROUND REALITY. Crop acreage hits 92% of normal as deficit narrows below 1%; paddy trails by 3%

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Sowing area under all kharif crops reached 92 per cent of the season's normal area of 1104.46 lakh hectares (lh), while the deficit from the year-ago level has narrowed to less than 1 per cent as of August 14.

However, the pace of sowing has slowed down during August 8-14 as the monsoon turned out to be 22 per cent deficient.

Farmers planted kharif crops on over 48 lh during August 8-14, compared to nearly 52 lh a year ago.

Despite the lower sowing in the past week, the overall deficit in sowing area further narrowed to less than 1 per cent from 1.8 per cent until August 7.

The sowing area in the on-going kharif season has reached 1,016.57 lh as of Au-

gust 14 compared with 1,037.52 lh in the year-ago period, the Agriculture Ministry said in its weekly update on Monday.

TRANSPLANTING PROGRESS

Paddy, the main cereal for the kharif season, is down by 3.7 per cent at 379.07 lakh hectares, compared to 393.44 lakh hectares a year ago. The deficit was 4.4 per cent until August 7, and narrowing of the gap indicates progress in transplanting during the past week.

The government has set a production target of 123.15 million tonnes (mt) of rice for kharif 2026, and there may not be any significant shortfall due to higher area coverage in major growing States.

PADDY SPREAD

Higher area coverage under paddy has been reported in

Kharif sowing* (lakh hectare)			
	2025	2026	% change
Paddy	393.44	379.07	-3.7
Pulses	108.49	108.14	-0.3
Shri Anna cum Coarse cereals	177.13	172.96	-2.4
Oilseeds	185.36	184.46	-0.5
Sugarcane	58.62	58.31	-0.9
Cotton	108.27	107.30	-0.5
All Crops	1,037.52	1,016.57	-0.9

*As of Aug 14; Source: Agriculture Ministry



Assam (3.93 lh), Ut-tarakhand (0.35 lh) and Ch-hattisgarh (0.09 lh).

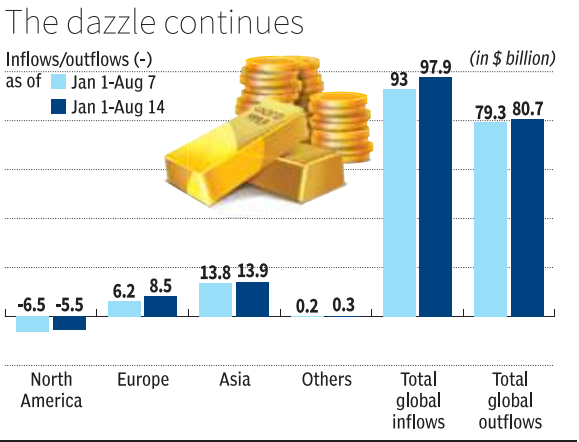
But a major decrease in area has been reported from Karnataka (by 2.86 lh), Jharkhand (2.26 lh), Maharashtra (2.25 lh), Odisha (2.09 lh), Madhya Pradesh (1.64 lh), Telan-gana (1.49 lh), Tamil Nadu (1.17 lakh ha), Andhra Pra-desh (1.14 lh), West Bengal (0.87 lh), Uttar Pradesh

(0.58 lh) and Bihar (0.52 lh). The area under all pulses reached 108.14 lakh hectares (lh) compared to 108.49 lakh hectares, while the area for oilseeds was 184.46 lakh hectares against 185.36 lakh hectares.

NUTRI-CEREALS DOWN Among pulses, arhar sowing reached 40.31 lh, down 4 per cent from 42.01 lh and

Positive inflows into gold ETFs continue for the 4th week in a row

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai



Prithviraj Kothari, Managing Director at RiddiSiddhi Bullions Ltd and President of the India Bullion and Jew-

ellers Association Ltd, said gold held on to most of last week's rally despite Friday's profit-taking.

Renisha Chainani, Chief Research Officer at Aug-mont, said the market will watch FOMC minutes, July industrial production data, the Philadelphia Fed Manu-facturing Index and flash Aug-ust PMIs.

Year-to-date, net invest-ments in ETFs are positive at \$17.22 billion, with \$97.88 billion inflows and \$80.66 billion outflows. China and India continued to keep in-flows into gold ETFs posi-tive, with investments to the tune of \$11 billion.

Last week, investors in the UK invested \$1.53 billion, while those from the US ad-ded \$1.04 billion. Other countries that chipped in were Germany and France,

with over \$300 million each, besides Japan, with \$174 billion.

US INFLOWS NEGATIVE Year-to-date, US investors have redeemed \$5.19 billion, while Canadians have with-drawn \$279 million, and exits in Italy are \$234 million.

In Asia, China's invest-ments are valued at \$7.01 bil-lion and India's at \$3.96 bil-lion.

Other countries in Asia whose investments are net positive are the Hong Kong Special Administrative Re-gion (\$960 million), Japan (\$844 million), South Korea (\$691 million) and Singa-pore (\$327 million).

Federal Court of Australia junks Apeda's 'word mark' appeal for Basmati rice

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai



India has been unsuccessful in getting the 'basmati' word mark registration in Australia, New Zealand and Kenya

The Federal Court of Aus-tralia has dismissed an appeal by the Agricultural and Pro-cessed Food Products Export Development Authority (Apeda), seeking registration of the single-word mark "bas-mati rice," akin to cham-pagne.

The federal court ruled that the word mark is not capable of distinguishing Apeda-certified goods from non-certified goods under Section 177(2) of Australia's Trade Marks Act, 1995.

Section 177 provides an additional ground for reject-ing an application or oppos-ing the registration of a certi-fication trade mark when it is not capable of distinguishing certified goods or services.

Section 177 (2) specifies that the registrar must take into account the extent to which the certification trade mark is inherently adapted to distinguish those goods or services. It stipulates that the registrar must decide the ex-tent to which the certifica-tion trade mark, because of its use or of any other cir-cumstances, has become ad-apted so as to distinguish those goods or services.

ONLY FOR WINES

Trade analysts and a GI ex-pert found a gap in the Indian government's approach to GI. In general, India should seek GI status for basmati.

"The New World countries (Australia, New Zealand, Canada and Australia) have GIs merely for wines. They do not have legislation to ad-dress the need of India's GI requirements. Hence, it has to seek word mark certifica-tion," said S Chandra-sekaran, author of *Basmati Rice: Natural History Geo-graphical Indication*. India should move the World Trade Organization to seek full implementation of Sec-

tion 3 of the Trade-Related Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS) Agreement in such member countries to get re-cognition for basmati and other unique products such as Darjeeling tea. "Probably, India should demand that unique agricultural products be given GI status," he said.

Trade analysts said when India was facing problems in getting a GI tag for its unique agricultural products, it should have got them in-cluded in its free trade agree-ments with various coun-tries, including Australia.

"If the EU can get GI status for its Prosecco wine, why can't we get similar status for basmati and other products? Pakistan agricul-ture was created through hy-draulic colonies just before 1947. India should have con-tested its case based on the historic reputation of bas-mati origin," said Chandrasekaran.

Apeda, the statutory body responsible for protecting and regulating Geographical Indication (GI) products, had appealed to the federal court against the Registrar of the Australian Trade Mark Office ruling on protection for the term "basmati" as a Geographical Indication.

Justice Dowling J dis-missed Apeda's appeal with costs, saying that he was not satisfied that a basmati trade mark "is capable of distin-guishing goods certified by Apeda from goods not certi-fied" by it.

Rice exporters seek Goyal's intervention on China's allegation of GMO presence in shipments

Our Bureau
New Delhi



TRADE SNAG. In March, China rejected three consignments of rice from three Indian exporters, saying that they had traces of GMOs and later suspended their licence

Seeking the government's intervention to restore the registrations of seven af-fected Indian rice exporters after China suspended them on alleged GMO contamina-tion in some consignments, the Rice Exporters Associ-ation of Chhattisgarh (TREACG) has urged Com-merce Minister Piyush Goyal to take up the matter with the Chinese authorities and facilitate an early joint tech-nical review.

Expressing concern over the issue, TREACG said both the Indian Council of Agri-cultural Research (ICAR) and the Genetic Engineering Appraisal Committee had clarified that commercial cultivation of genetically modified (GM) rice is not permitted in India.

"Further, the concerned export consignments had

undergone the prescribed non-GMO testing and certi-fication process prior to shipment from India," TREACG said in a statement.

KEY TECHNICAL ISSUE

According to the association, differing GMO-related test results reported at the des-tination despite non-GMO testing and certification at the origin constitute an im-portant technical matter.

Therefore, the issue merits scientific, transparent and fact-based engagement

between the competent au-thorities of both countries.

TREACG, in a letter, urged Goyal to take up the matter with the Chinese govern-ment and facilitate a tech-nical review and restoration of the General Administra-tion of Customs of China (GACC) registrations of the affected companies.

It suggested that a joint scientific and technical re-view may be undertaken by the competent authorities of both countries. Such an initi-ative could help identify the

reasons for differences in the test results and establish a transparent and mutually ac-ceptable mechanism to pre-vent recurrence of similar is-sues in the future, it said.

According to Mukesh Jain, President of TREACG, an early, positive and amicable resolution would be an im-portant step towards main-taining confidence and con-tinuity in India-China rice trade, safeguarding India's agricultural export interests and protecting Indian ex-porters, particularly MSMEs, from avoidable fi-nancial and commercial difficulties.

In March, China rejected three consignments of rice from three Indian exporters, saying that they had traces of GMOs and later suspended their licences.

As the rejection of rice consignments increased on the same grounds, the names of four more companies were added to the list.

Sunkind in talks with farmers and developers to set up agrivoltaic projects

Our Bureau
Chennai



Hanish Gupta, Founder and MD, Sunkind India

Integrated solar power solu-tions provider Sunkind India Ltd is in talks with farmers and developers to set up ag-rivoltaic projects in three States, founder and MD Han-ish Gupta said. "Current ag-rivoltaic projects and discus-sions are concentrated in Rajasthan, Odisha and Uttar Pradesh with the company supplying structures and seeking full project partner-ships," he told *businessline* in an online interaction.

Till now, engagements have been mainly for the sup-ply of structures rather than direct farmer deals. "Cur-rently, projects with farmers are in discussion but not fully closed," he said.

The benefit of agrivoltaics

ergy integration," said Gupta. The cooler microcli-mate under solar panels be-nefits crops. Water used for washing solar panels is re-used for irrigation, reducing input costs.

AWARENESS NEEDED

"Farmers can earn income by leasing land, investing in solar plants or using govern-ment schemes like PM Kusum that provide fixed, long-term payments," he said. However, more aware-ness and trust-building are needed to shift from struc-tured supply to full projects.

This results in predictable income streams independ-ent of agricultural market volatility. The PM Kusum scheme reduces diesel de-pendency and unreliable grid power, lowering farm input costs, Gupta said.

Sell natural gas futures if prices move up to ₹258

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau



Natural gas futures (₹254/mmBtu) gained a little over 3 per cent last week. However, they could not surpass the barrier and have fallen off that level.

COMMODITY CALL.

August futures faced stiff resistance at ₹270, and the price slipped during the second half of last week. On Monday, too, the price of the contract dropped, and it is on a weak footing. The price action suggests a clear bear-ish bias. There is a good chance that natural gas fu-tures will breach the nearby support at ₹250 and extend the decline to ₹238.

On the other hand, if nat-

ural gas futures recover from the current level, they will face a barrier at ₹270. Until this level holds, the outlook will remain weak.

Only a decisive breakout of ₹270 will turn the outlook positive. In this case, the contract could rise to ₹285, its 50-day moving average.

There is another resist-ance at ₹290. So, the price re-gion between ₹285 and ₹290 will be a considerable supply zone.

TRADE STRATEGY

Traders can sell natural gas futures (August) if the price moves up to ₹258. Target and stop-loss can be ₹238 and ₹270, respectively.

Beforest shows how regenerative farming can strengthen climate resilience

AJ Vinayak
Mangaluru



Sunith Reddy, CEO, Beforest Lifestyle Solutions

At a time when the country is facing erratic rainfall and rising temperatures, regen-erative farming could offer resi-lience to climate change, if the experience of Beforest is any indication.

Beforest is a regenerative land restoration initiative working at the intersection of agriculture, ecology and cli-mate resilience. It has built six collectives in Kodagu, Hy-derabad, Mumbai and Bhopal.

According to Sunith Reddy, Founder and CEO of Beforest Lifestyle Solutions, a collec-tive is a group of people bound by a shared commitment to regenerative living who co-own and co-manage a single landscape, with a minimum land requirement of about 100 acres. "The integrated

ecological systems we build (lakes, check dams, food forests, wilderness and wild-life corridors) simply can't function on a smaller base," he said. Members own private plots but share stewardship of the larger landscape. The collective's built-up footprint has been capped at 15 per cent of the land, so the ecology remains intact.

Reddy told *businessline* in an online interaction that Be-forest's idea took physical form in 2019 with its first col-

lective, Poomaale 1.0, in Kakkabe, Kodagu, where it began revilding an aban-doned coffee estate into a cof-fee forest, involving 50 fami-lies. Next, it launched the Hyderabad Collective, co-owned by 82 families. Poomaale 2.0 in Kodagu has 24 families, with scope for 11 more. The Mumbai Collec-tive has 33 families, with scope for another 10 to join. The Hammiyala collective in Kod-agu and the Bhopal collective are starting their journey with five and two members.

In all, six collectives have been built on around 1,300 acres with 196 members across them. Asked if the re-generative landscapes had proved more resilient than neighbouring conventional farms at a time when the country is facing erratic rain-fall and rising temperatures, he replied in the affirmative.

Two equity long-short strategies designed to pursue growth across market segments while actively managing market exposure and downside risk.



NFO closes on 24th August, 2026

Apex Equity Long-Short Fund (An open ended equity investment strategy investing in listed equity and equity related instruments including limited short exposure in equity through derivative instruments)		
This product is suitable for investors who are seeking*	Risk-band	Benchmark Risk-band (NIFTY 500 TRI)
- Capital appreciation over long term - An open ended equity investment strategy investing in listed equity and equity related instruments including limited short exposure in equity through derivative instruments.	RISK BAND LOWER RISK HIGHER RISK RISK-LEVEL 5	RISK BAND LOWER RISK HIGHER RISK RISK-LEVEL 3

Apex Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short Fund (An open ended investment strategy investing in equity and equity related instruments including limited short exposure in equity through derivative instruments of Ex - top 100 stocks)		
This product is suitable for investors who are seeking*	Risk-band	Benchmark Risk-band (NIFTY 500 TRI)
- Capital appreciation over long term - An open ended investment strategy investing in equity and equity related instruments including limited short exposure in equity through derivative instruments of Ex - top 100 stocks	RISK BAND LOWER RISK HIGHER RISK RISK-LEVEL 5	RISK BAND LOWER RISK HIGHER RISK RISK-LEVEL 3

SEBI Registration No. MF/020/94/8

Investments in Specialized Investment Fund involves relatively higher risk including potential loss of capital, liquidity risk and market volatility. Please read all investment strategy related documents carefully before making the investment decision.

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link <https://bit.ly/2FpossK>

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	699.15 692.65 702.50 714.00 688.00 168.85 814.55 287.00															12.29 12.28 938.90 12.87 9.69														
QMS Fuel	1541.90 1561.10 1758.50 1585.00 1535.00 198.73 1707.55 773.50															82.46 82.60 3014.02 84.11 58.91														
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Quantad	131.92 138.13 137.80 140.00 130.00 124.58 140.00 98.05															38.78 38.95 163.60 42.82 29.00														
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QualityPower	1249.30 1302.60 1260.00 131.70 1256.10 532.38 1441.00 581.00															23.98 23.98 5110.23 24.57 19.00														
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BSF Stocks

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360 One U (1)	1166.00	1170.65	ASX Auto (1)	648.00	648.90	Clean Max E (1)	1241.15	1239.00	Fernanta B (5)	449.40	458.25	HCP Plastiane	222.60	244.85	Juniper Green	251.50	241.90	M & B Engineer	270.15	283.90	Nykaa (1)	331.00	327.15	Rubicon Res (1)	1617.95	1798.30	Solarworld (1)	158.35	154.30	Tega Ind	1704.35	1740.85	Vikram Solar L	160.15	183.35	360 One U (1)	1166.00	1170.65	ASX Tech (1)	4836.75	4495.50	Clean Sci E (1)	821.25	839.90	Fidelity Flash (1)	0.19	0.19	Hydro Plastics	666.75	684.35	Juniper Life (2)	216.20	315.55	MacroTech B	1240.00	1255.00	Rudra Global (5)	22.25	23.82	Solar Energy L	188.40	788.30	Tega Ind	1704.35	1740.85	Vikram Solar L	160.15	183.35	Aadhar Pk (1)	489.00	487.35	AssoAlcohol	171.45	730.45	Cms Info T (2)	213.10	215.20	Finkurve (1)	72.93	72.92	Heranba Ind	169.85	165.35	Jyoti CNC (2)	825.80	857.75	Madhuver (1)	162.70	166.85	OmniTech En	127.57	565.20	TennoCeCo	538.85	548.20	Vikram Eng (1)	62.30	62.50	Aarthi Pk (1)	852.15	892.55	AssoAlcohol	171.45	730.45	Cms Info T (2)	213.10	215.20	Finkurve (1)	72.93	72.92	Heranba Ind	169.85	165.35	Jyoti CNC (2)	825.80	857.75	Madhuver (1)	162.70	166.85	OmniTech En	127.57	565.20	TennoCeCo	538.85	548.20	Vikram Eng (1)	62.30	62.50	Aarthi Pk (1)	852.15	892.55	AssoAlcohol	171.45	730.45	Cms Info T (2)	213.10	215.20	Finkurve (1)	72.93	72.92	Heranba Ind	169.85	165.35	Jyoti CNC (2)	825.80	857.75	Madhuver (1)	162.70	166.85	OmniTech En	127.57	565.20	TennoCeCo	538.85	548.20	Vikram Eng (1)	62.30	62.50	Aarthi Pk (1)	852.15	892.55	AssoAlcohol	171.45	730.45	Cms Info T (2)	213.10	215.20	Finkurve (1)	72.93	72.92	Heranba Ind	169.85	165.35	Jyoti CNC (2)	825.80	857.75	Madhuver (1)	162.70	166.85	OmniTech En	127.57	565.20	TennoCeCo	538.85	548.20	Vikram Eng (1)	62.30	62.50	Aarthi Pk (1)	852.15	892.55	AssoAlcohol	171.45	730.45	Cms Info T (2)	213.10	215.20	Finkurve (1)	72.93	72.92	Heranba Ind	169.85	165.35	Jyoti CNC (2)	825.80	857.75	Madhuver (1)	162.70	166.85	OmniTech En	127.57	565.20	TennoCeCo	538.85	548.20	Vikram Eng (1)	62.30	62.50	Aarthi Pk (1)	852.15	892.55	AssoAlcohol	171.45	730.45	Cms Info T (2)	213.10	215.20	Finkurve (1)	72.93	72.92	Heranba Ind	169.85	165.35	Jyoti CNC (2)	825.80	857.75	Madhuver (1)	162.70	166.85	OmniTech En	127.57	565.20	TennoCeCo	538.85	548.20	Vikram Eng (1)	62.30	62.50	Aarthi Pk (1)	852.15	892.55	AssoAlcohol	171.45	730.45	Cms Info T (2)	213.10	215.20	Finkurve (1)	72.93	72.92	Heranba Ind	169.85	165.35	Jyoti CNC (2)	825.80	857.75	Madhuver (1)	162.70	166.85	OmniTech En	127.57	565.20	TennoCeCo	538.85	548.20	Vikram Eng (1)	62.30	62.50	Aarthi Pk (1)	852.15	892.55	AssoAlcohol	171.45	730.45	Cms Info T (2)	213.10	215.20	Finkurve (1)	72.93	72.92	Heranba Ind	169.85	165.35	Jyoti CNC (2)	825.80	857.75	Madhuver (1)	162.70	166.85	OmniTech En	127.57	565.20	TennoCeCo	538.85	548.20	Vikram Eng (1)	62.30	62.50	Aarthi Pk (1)	852.15	892.55	AssoAlcohol	171.45	730.45	Cms Info T (2)	213.10	215.20	Finkurve (1)	72.93	72.92	Heranba Ind	169.85	165.35	Jyoti CNC (2)	825.80	857.75	Madhuver (1)	162.70	166.85	OmniTech En	127.57	565.20	TennoCeCo	538.85	548.20	Vikram Eng (1)	62.30	62.50	Aarthi Pk (1)	852.15	892.55	AssoAlcohol	171.45	730.45	Cms Info T (2)	213.10	215.20	Finkurve (1)	72.93	72.92	Heranba Ind	169.85	165.35	Jyoti CNC (2)	825.80	857.75	Madhuver (1)	162.70	166.85	OmniTech En	127.57	565.20	TennoCeCo	538.85	548.20	Vikram Eng (1)	62.30	62.50	Aarthi Pk (

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